

The Cellular Concept — System Design Fundamentals

The design objective of early mobile radio systems was to achieve a large coverage area by using a single, high powered transmitter with an antenna mounted on a tall tower. While this approach achieved very good coverage, it also meant that it was impossible to reuse those same frequencies throughout the system, since any attempts to achieve frequency reuse would result in interference. For example, the Bell mobile system in New York City in the 1970s could only support a maximum of twelve simultaneous calls over a thousand square miles [Cal88]. Faced with the fact that government regulatory agencies could not make spectrum allocations in proportion to the increasing demand for mobile services, it became imperative to restructure the radio telephone system to achieve high capacity with limited radio spectrum, while at the same time covering very large areas.

2.1 Introduction

The cellular concept was a major breakthrough in solving the problem of spectral congestion and user capacity. It offered very high capacity in a limited spectrum allocation without any major technological changes. The cellular concept is a system level idea which calls for replacing a single, high power transmitter (large cell) with many low power transmitters (small cells), each providing coverage to only a small portion of the service area. Each base station is allocated a portion of the total number of channels available to the entire system, and nearby base stations are assigned different groups of channels so that all the available channels are assigned to a relatively small number of neighboring base stations. Neighboring base stations are assigned different groups of channels so that the interference between base stations (and the mobile users

under their control) is minimized. By systematically spacing base stations and their channel groups throughout a market, the available channels are distributed throughout the geographic region and may be reused as many times as necessary, so long as the interference between co-channel stations is kept below acceptable levels.

As the demand for service increases (i.e., as more channels are needed within a particular market), the number of base stations may be increased (along with a corresponding decrease in transmitter power to avoid added interference), thereby providing additional radio capacity with no additional increase in radio spectrum. This fundamental principle is the foundation for all modern wireless communication systems, since it enables a fixed number of channels to serve an arbitrarily large number of subscribers by reusing the channels throughout the coverage region. Furthermore, the cellular concept allows every piece of subscriber equipment within a country or continent to be manufactured with the same set of channels, so that any mobile may be used anywhere within the region.

2.2 Frequency Reuse

Cellular radio systems rely on an intelligent allocation and reuse of channels throughout a coverage region [Oet83]. Each cellular base station is allocated a group of radio channels to be used within a small geographic area called a *cell*. Base stations in adjacent cells are assigned channel groups which contain completely different channels than neighboring cells. The base station antennas are designed to achieve the desired coverage within the particular cell. By limiting the coverage area to within the boundaries of a cell, the same group of channels may be used to cover different cells that are separated from one another by distances large enough to keep interference levels within tolerable limits. The design process of selecting and allocating channel groups for all of the cellular base stations within a system is called *frequency reuse* or *frequency planning* [Mac79].

Figure 2.1 illustrates the concept of cellular frequency reuse, where cells labeled with the same letter use the same group of channels. The frequency reuse plan is overlaid upon a map to indicate where different frequency channels are used. The hexagonal cell shape shown in Figure 2.1 is conceptual and is a simplistic model of the radio coverage for each base station, but it has been universally adopted since the hexagon permits easy and manageable analysis of a cellular system. The actual radio coverage of a cell is known as the *footprint* and is determined from field measurements or propagation prediction models. Although the real footprint is amorphous in nature, a regular cell shape is needed for systematic system design and adaptation for future growth. While it might seem natural to choose a circle to represent the coverage area of a base station, adjacent circles can not be overlaid upon a map without leaving gaps or

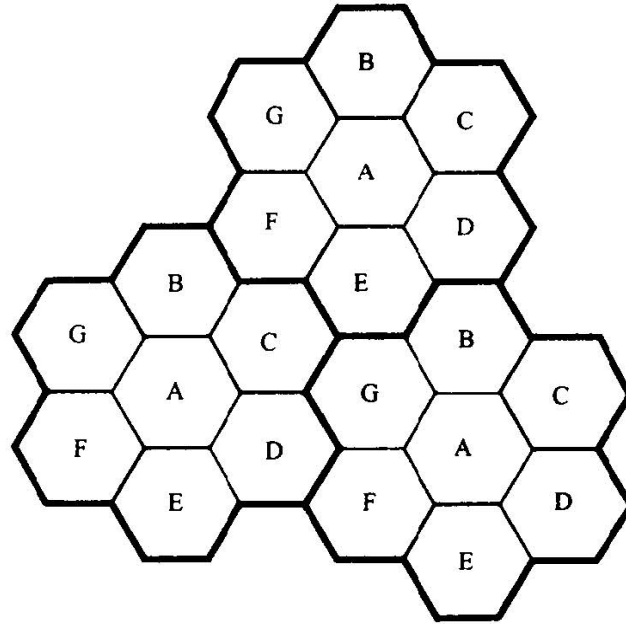


Figure 2.1

Illustration of the cellular frequency reuse concept. Cells with the same letter use the same set of frequencies. A cell cluster is outlined in bold and replicated over the coverage area. In this example, the cluster size, N , is equal to seven, and the frequency reuse factor is $1/7$ since each cell contains one-seventh of the total number of available channels.

creating overlapping regions. Thus, when considering geometric shapes which cover an entire region without overlap and with equal area, there are three sensible choices: a square; an equilateral triangle; and a hexagon. A cell must be designed to serve the weakest mobiles within the footprint, and these are typically located at the edge of the cell. For a given distance between the center of a polygon and its farthest perimeter points, the hexagon has the largest area of the three. Thus, by using the hexagon geometry, the fewest number of cells can cover a geographic region, and the hexagon closely approximates a circular radiation pattern which would occur for an omni-directional base station antenna and free space propagation. Of course, the actual cellular footprint is determined by the contour in which a given transmitter serves the mobiles successfully.

When using hexagons to model coverage areas, base station transmitters are depicted as either being in the center of the cell (center-excited cells) or on three of the six cell vertices (edge-excited cells). Normally, omni-directional antennas are used in center-excited cells and sectorized directional antennas are used in corner-excited cells. Practical considerations usually do not allow base stations to be placed exactly as they appear in the hexagonal layout. Most system designs permit a base station to be positioned up to one-fourth the cell radius away from the ideal location.

To understand the frequency reuse concept, consider a cellular system which has a total of S duplex channels available for use. If each cell is allocated a group of k channels ($k < S$), and if the S channels are divided among N cells into unique and disjoint channel groups which each have the same number of channels, the total number of available radio channels can be expressed as

$$S = kN \quad (2.1)$$

The N cells which collectively use the complete set of available frequencies is called a *cluster*. If a cluster is replicated M times within the system, the total number of duplex channels, C , can be used as a measure of capacity and is given

$$C = MkN = MS \quad (2.2)$$

As seen from equation (2.2), the capacity of a cellular system is directly proportional to the number of times a cluster is replicated in a fixed service area. The factor N is called the *cluster size* and is typically equal to 4, 7, or 12. If the cluster size N is reduced while the cell size is kept constant, more clusters are required to cover a given area and hence more capacity (a larger value of C) is achieved. A large cluster size indicates that the ratio between the cell radius and the distance between co-channel cells is large. Conversely, a small cluster size indicates that co-channel cells are located much closer together. The value for N is a function of how much interference a mobile or base station can tolerate while maintaining a sufficient quality of communications. From a design viewpoint, the smallest possible value of N is desirable in order to maximize capacity over a given coverage area (i.e., to maximize C in equation (2.2)). The *frequency reuse factor* of a cellular system is given by $1/N$, since each cell within a cluster is only assigned $1/N$ of the total available channels in the system.

Due to the fact that the hexagonal geometry of Figure 2.1 has exactly six equidistant neighbors and that the lines joining the centers of any cell and each of its neighbors are separated by multiples of 60 degrees, there are only certain cluster sizes and cell layouts which are possible [Mac79]. In order to tessellate — to connect without gaps between adjacent cells — the geometry of hexagons is such that the number of cells per cluster, N , can only have values which satisfy equation (2.3).

$$N = i^2 + ij + j^2 \quad (2.3)$$

where i and j are non-negative integers. To find the nearest co-channel neighbors of a particular cell, one must do the following: (1) move i cells along any chain of hexagons and then (2) turn 60 degrees counter-clockwise and move j cells. This is illustrated in Figure 2.2 for $i = 3$ and $j = 2$ (example, $N = 19$).

Example 2.1

If a total of 33 MHz of bandwidth is allocated to a particular FDD cellular telephone system which uses two 25 kHz simplex channels to provide full duplex

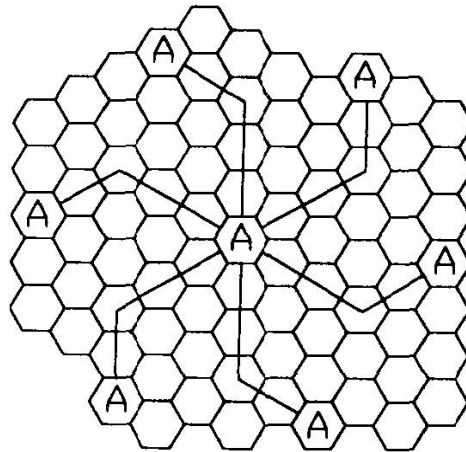


Figure 2.2

Method of locating co-channel cells in a cellular system. In this example, $N = 19$ (i.e., $i = 3, j = 2$). [Adapted from [Oet83] © IEEE].

voice and control channels, compute the number of channels available per cell if a system uses (a) 4-cell reuse, (b) 7-cell reuse (c) 12-cell reuse. If 1 MHz of the allocated spectrum is dedicated to control channels, determine an equitable distribution of control channels and voice channels in each cell for each of the three systems.

Solution to Example 2.1

Given:

Total bandwidth = 33 MHz

Channel bandwidth = $25 \text{ kHz} \times 2 \text{ simplex channels} = 50 \text{ kHz/duplex channel}$

Total available channels = $33,000/50 = 660$ channels

(a) For $N = 4$,

total number of channels available per cell = $660/4 \approx 165$ channels.

(b) For $N = 7$,

total number of channels available per cell = $660/7 \approx 95$ channels.

(c) For $N = 12$,

total number of channels available per cell = $660/12 \approx 55$ channels.

A 1 MHz spectrum for control channels implies that there are $1000/50 = 20$ control channels out of the 660 channels available. To evenly distribute the control and voice channels, simply allocate the same number of channels in each cell wherever possible. Here, the 660 channels must be evenly distributed to each cell within the cluster. In practice, only the 640 voice channels would be allocated, since the control channels are allocated separately as 1 per cell.

(a) For $N = 4$, we can have 5 control channels and 160 voice channels per cell. In practice, however, each cell only needs a single control channel (the control

channels have a greater reuse distance than the voice channels). Thus, one control channel and 160 voice channels would be assigned to each cell.

(b) For $N = 7$, 4 cells with 3 control channels and 92 voice channels, 2 cells with 3 control channels and 90 voice channels, and 1 cell with 2 control channels and 92 voice channels could be allocated. In practice, however, each cell would have one control channel, four cells would have 91 voice channels, and three cells would have 92 voice channels.

(c) For $N = 12$, we can have 8 cells with 2 control channels and 53 voice channels, and 4 cells with 1 control channel and 54 voice channels each. In an actual system, each cell would have 1 control channel, 8 cells would have 53 voice channels, and 4 cells would have 54 voice channels.

2.3 Channel Assignment Strategies

For efficient utilization of the radio spectrum, a frequency reuse scheme that is consistent with the objectives of increasing capacity and minimizing interference is required. A variety of channel assignment strategies have been developed to achieve these objectives. Channel assignment strategies can be classified as either *fixed* or *dynamic*. The choice of channel assignment strategy impacts the performance of the system, particularly as to how calls are managed when a mobile user is handed off from one cell to another [Tek91], [LiC93], [Sun94], [Rap93b].

In a fixed channel assignment strategy, each cell is allocated a predetermined set of voice channels. Any call attempt within the cell can only be served by the unused channels in that particular cell. If all the channels in that cell are occupied, the call is *blocked* and the subscriber does not receive service. Several variations of the fixed assignment strategy exist. In one approach, called the *borrowing strategy*, a cell is allowed to borrow channels from a neighboring cell if all of its own channels are already occupied. The mobile switching center (MSC) supervises such borrowing procedures and ensures that the borrowing of a channel does not disrupt or interfere with any of the calls in progress in the donor cell.

In a dynamic channel assignment strategy, voice channels are not allocated to different cells permanently. Instead, each time a call request is made, the serving base station requests a channel from the MSC. The switch then allocates a channel to the requested cell following an algorithm that takes into account the likelihood of future blocking within the cell, the frequency of use of the candidate channel, the reuse distance of the channel, and other cost functions.

Accordingly, the MSC only allocates a given frequency if that frequency is not presently in use in the cell or any other cell which falls within the minimum restricted distance of frequency reuse to avoid co-channel interference. Dynamic channel assignment reduce the likelihood of blocking, which increases the trunking capacity of the system, since all the available channels in a market are accessible to all of the cells. Dynamic channel assignment strategies require the MSC

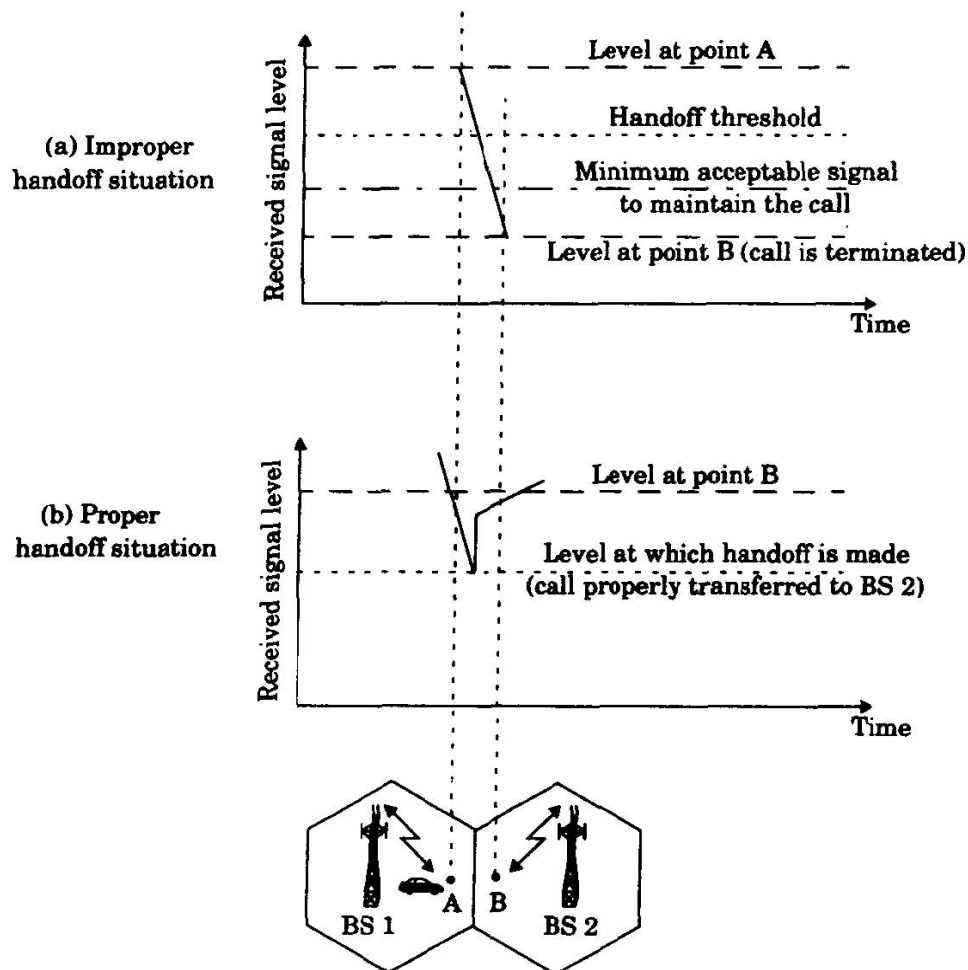


Figure 2.3
Illustration of a handoff scenario at cell boundary.

to collect real-time data on channel occupancy, traffic distribution, and *radio signal strength indications* (RSSI) of all channels on a continuous basis. This increases the storage and computational load on the system but provides the advantage of increased channel utilization and decreased probability of a blocked call.

2.4 Handoff Strategies

When a mobile moves into a different cell while a conversation is in progress, the MSC automatically transfers the call to a new channel belonging to the new base station. This handoff operation not only involves identifying a new base station, but also requires that the voice and control signals be allocated to channels associated with the new base station.

Processing handoffs is an important task in any cellular radio system. Many handoff strategies prioritize handoff requests over call initiation requests when allocating unused channels in a cell site. Handoffs must be performed successfully and as infrequently as possible, and be imperceptible to the users. In order to meet these requirements, system designers must specify an optimum signal level at which to initiate a handoff. Once a particular signal level is specified as the minimum usable signal for acceptable voice quality at the base station receiver (normally taken as between -90 dBm and -100 dBm), a slightly stronger signal level is used as a threshold at which a handoff is made. This margin, given by $\Delta = P_{r \text{ handoff}} - P_{r \text{ minimum usable}}$, cannot be too large or too small. If Δ is too large, unnecessary handoffs which burden the MSC may occur, and if Δ is too small, there may be insufficient time to complete a handoff before a call is lost due to weak signal conditions. Therefore, Δ is chosen carefully to meet these conflicting requirements. Figure 2.3 illustrates a handoff situation. Figure 2.3(a) demonstrates the case where a handoff is not made and the signal drops below the minimum acceptable level to keep the channel active. This dropped call event can happen when there is an excessive delay by the MSC in assigning a handoff, or when the threshold Δ is set too small for the handoff time in the system. Excessive delays may occur during high traffic conditions due to computational loading at the MSC or due to the fact that no channels are available on any of the nearby base stations (thus forcing the MSC to wait until a channel in a nearby cell becomes free).

In deciding when to handoff, it is important to ensure that the drop in the measured signal level is not due to momentary fading and that the mobile is actually moving away from the serving base station. In order to ensure this, the base station monitors the signal level for a certain period of time before a handoff is initiated. This running average measurement of signal strength should be optimized so that unnecessary handoffs are avoided, while ensuring that necessary handoffs are completed before a call is terminated due to poor signal level. The length of time needed to decide if a handoff is necessary depends on the speed at which the vehicle is moving. If the slope of the short-term average received signal level in a given time interval is steep, the handoff should be made quickly. Information about the vehicle speed, which can be useful in handoff decisions, can also be computed from the statistics of the received short-term fading signal at the base station.

The time over which a call may be maintained within a cell, without handoff, is called the *dwell time* [Rap93b]. The dwell time of a particular user is governed by a number of factors, which include propagation, interference, distance between the subscriber and the base station, and other time varying effects. Chapter 4 shows that even when a mobile user is stationary, ambient motion in the vicinity of the base station and the mobile can produce fading, thus even a stationary subscriber may have a random and finite dwell time. Analysis in

[Rap93b] indicates that the statistics of dwell time vary greatly, depending on the speed of the user and the type of radio coverage. For example, in mature cells which provide coverage for vehicular highway users, most users tend to have a relatively constant speed and travel along fixed and well-defined paths with good radio coverage. In such instances, the dwell time for an arbitrary user is a random variable with a distribution that is highly concentrated about the mean dwell time. On the other hand, for users in dense, cluttered microcell environments, there is typically a large variation of dwell time about the mean, and the dwell times are typically shorter than the cell geometry would otherwise suggest. It is apparent that the statistics of dwell time are important in the practical design of handoff algorithms [LiC93], [Sun94], [Rap93b].

In first generation analog cellular systems, signal strength measurements are made by the base stations and supervised by the MSC. Each base station constantly monitors the signal strengths of all of its reverse voice channels to determine the relative location of each mobile user with respect to the base station tower. In addition to measuring the RSSI of calls in progress within the cell, a spare receiver in each base station, called the locator receiver, is used to determine signal strengths of mobile users which are in neighboring cells. The *locator receiver* is controlled by the MSC and is used to monitor the signal strength of users in neighboring cells which appear to be in need of handoff and reports all RSSI values to the MSC. Based on the locator receiver signal strength information from each base station, the MSC decides if a handoff is necessary or not.

In second generation systems that use digital TDMA technology, handoff decisions are *mobile assisted*. In *mobile assisted handoff* (MAHO), every mobile station measures the received power from surrounding base stations and continually reports the results of these measurements to the serving base station. A handoff is initiated when the power received from the base station of a neighboring cell begins to exceed the power received from the current base station by a certain level or for a certain period of time. The MAHO method enables the call to be handed over between base stations at a much faster rate than in first generation analog systems since the handoff measurements are made by each mobile, and the MSC no longer constantly monitors signal strengths. MAHO is particularly suited for microcellular environments where handoffs are more frequent.

During the course of a call, if a mobile moves from one cellular system to a different cellular system controlled by a different MSC, an *intersystem handoff* becomes necessary. An MSC engages in an intersystem handoff when a mobile signal becomes weak in a given cell and the MSC cannot find another cell within its system to which it can transfer the call in progress. There are many issues that must be addressed when implementing an intersystem handoff. For instance, a local call may become a long-distance call as the mobile moves out of its home system and becomes a roamer in a neighboring system. Also, compati-

bility between the two MSCs must be determined before implementing an inter-system handoff. Chapter 9 demonstrates how intersystem handoffs are implemented in practice.

Different systems have different policies and methods for managing handoff requests. Some systems handle handoff requests in the same way they handle originating calls. In such systems, the probability that a handoff request will not be served by a new base station is equal to the blocking probability of incoming calls. However, from the user's point of view, having a call abruptly terminated while in the middle of a conversation is more annoying than being blocked occasionally on a new call attempt. To improve the quality of service as perceived by the users, various methods have been devised to prioritize handoff requests over call initiation requests when allocating voice channels.

2.4.1 Prioritizing Handoffs

One method for giving priority to handoffs is called the *guard channel concept*, whereby a fraction of the total available channels in a cell is reserved exclusively for handoff requests from ongoing calls which may be handed off into the cell. This method has the disadvantage of reducing the total carried traffic, as fewer channels are allocated to originating calls. Guard channels, however, offer efficient spectrum utilization when dynamic channel assignment strategies, which minimize the number of required guard channels by efficient demand-based allocation, are used.

Queuing of handoff requests is another method to decrease the probability of forced termination of a call due to lack of available channels. There is a trade-off between the decrease in probability of forced termination and total carried traffic. Queuing of handoffs is possible due to the fact that there is a finite time interval between the time the received signal level drops below the handoff threshold and the time the call is terminated due to insufficient signal level. The delay time and size of the queue is determined from the traffic pattern of the particular service area. It should be noted that queuing does not guarantee a zero probability of forced termination, since large delays will cause the received signal level to drop below the minimum required level to maintain communication and hence lead to forced termination.

2.4.2 Practical Handoff Considerations

In practical cellular systems, several problems arise when attempting to design for a wide range of mobile velocities. High speed vehicles pass through the coverage region of a cell within a matter of seconds, whereas pedestrian users may never need a handoff during a call. Particularly with the addition of microcells to provide capacity, the MSC can quickly become burdened if high speed users are constantly being passed between very small cells. Several schemes have been devised to handle the simultaneous traffic of high speed and

low speed users while minimizing the handoff intervention from the MSC. Another practical limitation is the ability to obtain new cell sites.

Although the cellular concept clearly provides additional capacity through the addition of cell sites, in practice it is difficult for cellular service providers to obtain new physical cell site locations in urban areas. Zoning laws, ordinances, and other nontechnical barriers often make it more attractive for a cellular provider to install additional channels and base stations at the same physical location of an existing cell, rather than find new site locations. By using different antenna heights (often on the same building or tower) and different power levels, it is possible to provide “large” and “small” cells which are co-located at a single location. This technique is called the *umbrella cell* approach and is used to provide large area coverage to high speed users while providing small area coverage to users traveling at low speeds. Figure 2.4 illustrates an umbrella cell which is co-located with some smaller microcells. The umbrella cell approach ensures that the number of handoffs is minimized for high speed users and provides additional microcell channels for pedestrian users. The speed of each user may be estimated by the base station or MSC by evaluating how rapidly the short-term average signal strength on the RVC changes over time, or more sophisticated algorithms may be used to evaluate and partition users [LiC93]. If a high speed user in the large umbrella cell is approaching the base station, and its velocity is rapidly decreasing, the base station may decide to hand the user into the co-located microcell, without MSC intervention.

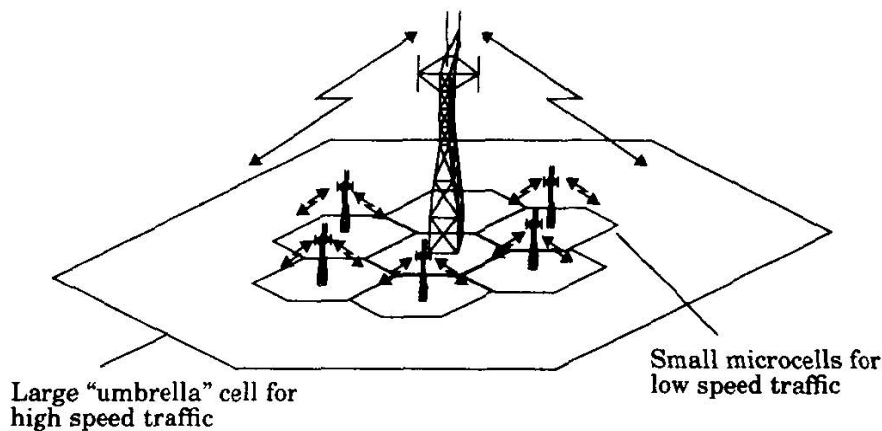


Figure 2.4
The umbrella cell approach.

Another practical handoff problem in microcell systems is known as *cell dragging*. Cell dragging results from pedestrian users that provide a very strong signal to the base station. Such a situation occurs in an urban environment when there is a line-of-sight (LOS) radio path between the subscriber and the base sta-

tion. As the user travels away from the base station at a very slow speed, the average signal strength does not decay rapidly. Even when the user has traveled well beyond the designed range of the cell, the received signal at the base station may be above the handoff threshold, thus a handoff may not be made. This creates a potential interference and traffic management problem, since the user has meanwhile traveled deep within a neighboring cell. To solve the cell dragging problem, handoff thresholds and radio coverage parameters must be adjusted carefully.

In first generation analog cellular systems, the typical time to make a handoff, once the signal level is deemed to be below the handoff threshold, is about 10 seconds. This requires that the value for Δ be on the order of 6 dB to 12 dB. In new digital cellular systems such as GSM, the mobile assists with the handoff procedure by determining the best handoff candidates, and the handoff, once the decision is made, typically requires only 1 or 2 seconds. Consequently, Δ is usually between 0 dB and 6 dB in modern cellular systems. The faster handoff process supports a much greater range of options for handling high speed and low speed users and provides the MSC with substantial time to “rescue” a call that is in need of handoff.

Another feature of newer cellular systems is the ability to make handoff decisions based on a wide range of metrics other than signal strength. The co-channel and adjacent channel interference levels may be measured at the base station or the mobile, and this information may be used with conventional signal strength data to provide a multi-dimensional algorithm for determining when a handoff is needed.

The IS-95 code division multiple access (CDMA) spread spectrum cellular system described in Chapter 10, provides a unique handoff capability that cannot be provided with other wireless systems. Unlike channelized wireless systems that assign different radio channels during a handoff (called a *hard handoff*), spread spectrum mobiles share the same channel in every cell. Thus, the term *handoff* does not mean a physical change in the assigned channel, but rather that a different base station handles the radio communication task. By simultaneously evaluating the received signals from a single subscriber at several neighboring base stations, the MSC may actually decide which version of the user’s signal is best at any moment in time. This technique exploits macroscopic space diversity provided by the different physical locations of the base stations and allows the MSC to make a “soft” decision as to which version of the user’s signal to pass along to the PSTN at any instance [Pad94]. The ability to select between the instantaneous received signals from a variety of base stations is called *soft handoff*.

2.5 Interference and System Capacity

Interference is the major limiting factor in the performance of cellular radio systems. Sources of interference include another mobile in the same cell, a call in progress in a neighboring cell, other base stations operating in the same frequency band, or any noncellular system which inadvertently leaks energy into the cellular frequency band. Interference on voice channels causes cross talk, where the subscriber hears interference in the background due to an undesired transmission. On control channels, interference leads to missed and blocked calls due to errors in the digital signaling. Interference is more severe in urban areas, due to the greater RF noise floor and the large number of base stations and mobiles. Interference has been recognized as a major bottleneck in increasing capacity and is often responsible for dropped calls. The two major types of system-generated cellular interference are *co-channel interference* and *adjacent channel interference*. Even though interfering signals are often generated within the cellular system, they are difficult to control in practice (due to random propagation effects). Even more difficult to control is interference due to out-of-band users, which arises without warning due to front end overload of subscriber equipment or intermittent intermodulation products. In practice, the transmitters from competing cellular carriers are often a significant source of out-of-band interference, since competitors often locate their base stations in close proximity to one another in order to provide comparable coverage to customers.

2.5.1 Co-channel Interference and System Capacity

Frequency reuse implies that in a given coverage area there are several cells that use the same set of frequencies. These cells are called *co-channel cells*, and the interference between signals from these cells is called *co-channel interference*. Unlike thermal noise which can be overcome by increasing the signal-to-noise ratio (SNR), co-channel interference cannot be combated by simply increasing the carrier power of a transmitter. This is because an increase in carrier transmit power increases the interference to neighboring co-channel cells. To reduce co-channel interference, co-channel cells must be physically separated by a minimum distance to provide sufficient isolation due to propagation.

When the size of each cell is approximately the same, and the base stations transmit the same power, the co-channel interference ratio is independent of the transmitted power and becomes a function of the radius of the cell (R) and the distance between centers of the nearest co-channel cells (D). By increasing the ratio of D/R , the spatial separation between co-channel cells relative to the coverage distance of a cell is increased. Thus interference is reduced from improved isolation of RF energy from the co-channel cell. The parameter Q , called the *co-channel reuse ratio*, is related to the cluster size. For a hexagonal geometry

$$Q = \frac{D}{R} = \sqrt{3N} \quad (2.4)$$

A small value of Q provides larger capacity since the cluster size N is small, whereas a large value of Q improves the transmission quality, due to a smaller level of co-channel interference. A trade-off must be made between these two objectives in actual cellular design.

Table 2.1 Co-channel Reuse Ratio for Some Values of N

	Cluster Size (N)	Co-channel Reuse Ratio(Q)
$i = 1, j = 1$	3	3
$i = 1, j = 2$	7	4.58
$i = 2, j = 2$	12	6
$i = 1, j = 3$	13	6.24

Let i_o be the number of co-channel interfering cells. Then, the signal-to-interference ratio (S/I or SIR) for a mobile receiver which monitors a forward channel can be expressed as

$$\frac{S}{I} = \frac{S}{\sum_{i=1}^{i_o} I_i} \quad (2.5)$$

where S is the desired signal power from the desired base station and I_i is the interference power caused by the i th interfering co-channel cell base station. If the signal levels of co-channel cells are known, then the S/I ratio for the forward link can be found using equation (2.5).

Propagation measurements in a mobile radio channel show that the average received signal strength at any point decays as a power law of the distance of separation between a transmitter and receiver. The average received power P_r at a distance d from the transmitting antenna is approximated by

$$P_r = P_0 \left(\frac{d}{d_0} \right)^{-n} \quad (2.6)$$

or

$$P_r \text{ (dBm)} = P_0 \text{ (dBm)} - 10n \log \left(\frac{d}{d_0} \right) \quad (2.7)$$

where P_0 is the power received at a close-in reference point in the far field region of the antenna at a small distance d_0 from the transmitting antenna, and n is the path loss exponent. Now consider the forward link where the desired signal is the serving base station and where the interference is due to co-channel base stations. If D_i is the distance of the i th interferer from the mobile, the received power at a given mobile due to the i th interfering cell will be proportional to

$(D_i)^{-n}$. The path loss exponent typically ranges between 2 and 4 in urban cellular systems [Rap92b].

When the transmit power of each base station is equal and the path loss exponent is the same throughout the coverage area, S/I for a mobile can be approximated as

$$\frac{S}{I} = \frac{R^{-n}}{\sum_{i=1}^{i_0} (D_i)^{-n}} \quad (2.8)$$

Considering only the first layer of interfering cells, if all the interfering base stations are equidistant from the desired base station and if this distance is equal to the distance D between cell centers, then equation (2.8) simplifies to

$$\frac{S}{I} = \frac{(D/R)^n}{i_0} = \frac{(\sqrt{3}N)^n}{i_0} \quad (2.9)$$

Equation (2.9) relates S/I to the cluster size N , which in turn determines the overall capacity of the system from equation (2.2). For example, assume that the six closest cells are close enough to create significant interference and that they are all approximately equal distance from the desired base station. For the U.S. AMPS cellular system which uses FM and 30 kHz channels, subjective tests indicate that sufficient voice quality is provided when S/I is greater than or equal to 18 dB. Using equation (2.9) it can be shown in order to meet this requirement, the cluster size N should be at least 6.49, assuming a path loss exponent $n = 4$. Thus a minimum cluster size of 7 is required to meet an S/I requirement of 18 dB. It should be noted that equation (2.9) is based on the hexagonal cell geometry where all the interfering cells are equidistant from the base station receiver, and hence provides an optimistic result in many cases. For some frequency reuse plans (e.g. $N = 4$), the closest interfering cells vary widely in their distances from the desired cell.

From Figure 2.5, it can be seen for a 7-cell cluster, with the mobile unit is at the cell boundary, the mobile is a distance $D - R$ from the two nearest co-channel interfering cells and approximately $D + R/2$, D , $D - R/2$, and $D + R$ from the other interfering cells in the first tier [Lee86]. Using equation (2.9) and assuming n equals 4, the signal-to-interference ratio for the worst case can be closely approximated as (an exact expression is worked out by Jacobsmeier [Jac94]).

$$\frac{S}{I} = \frac{R^{-4}}{2(D - R)^{-4} + 2(D + R)^{-4} + 2D^{-4}} \quad (2.10)$$

Equation (2.10) can be rewritten in terms of the co-channel reuse ratio Q , as

$$\frac{S}{I} = \frac{1}{2(Q-1)^{-4} + 2(Q+1)^{-4} + 2Q^{-4}} \quad (2.11)$$

For $N = 7$, the co-channel reuse ratio Q is 4.6, and the worst case S/I is approximated as 49.56 (17 dB) using equation (2.11), whereas an exact solution using equation (2.8) yields 17.8 dB [Jac94]. Hence for a 7-cell cluster, the S/I ratio is slightly less than 18 dB for the worst case. To design the cellular system for proper performance in the worst case, it would be necessary to increase N to the next largest size, which from equation (2.3) is found to be 12 (corresponding to $i = j = 2$). This obviously entails a significant decrease in capacity, since 12-cell reuse offers a spectrum utilization of $1/12$ within each cell, whereas 7-cell reuse offers a spectrum utilization of $1/7$. In practice, a capacity reduction of $7/12$ would not be tolerable to accommodate for the worst case situation which rarely occurs. From the above discussion it is clear that co-channel interference determines link performance, which in turn dictates the frequency reuse plan and the overall capacity of cellular systems.

Example 2.2

If a signal to interference ratio of 15 dB is required for satisfactory forward channel performance of a cellular system, what is the frequency reuse factor and cluster size that should be used for maximum capacity if the path loss exponent is (a) $n = 4$, (b) $n = 3$? Assume that there are 6 co-channels cells in the first tier, and all of them are at the same distance from the mobile. Use suitable approximations.

Solution to Example 2.2

(a) $n = 4$

First, let us consider a 7-cell reuse pattern.

Using equation (2.4), the co-channel reuse ratio $D/R = 4.583$.

Using equation (2.9), the signal-to-noise interference ratio is given by

$$S/I = (1/6) \times (4.583)^4 = 75.3 = 18.66 \text{ dB.}$$

Since this is greater than the minimum required S/I , $N = 7$ can be used.

b) $n = 3$

First, let us consider a 7-cell reuse pattern.

Using equation (2.9), the signal-to-interference ratio is given by

$$S/I = (1/6) \times (4.583)^3 = 16.04 = 12.05 \text{ dB.}$$

Since this is less than the minimum required S/I , we need to use a larger N .

Using equation (2.3), the next possible value of N is 12, ($i = j = 2$).

The corresponding co-channel ratio is given by equation (2.4) as

$$D/R = 6.0.$$

Using equation (2.3) the signal-to-interference ratio is given by

$$S/I = (1/6) \times (6)^3 = 36 = 15.56 \text{ dB.}$$

Since this is greater than the minimum required S/I , $N = 12$ can be used.

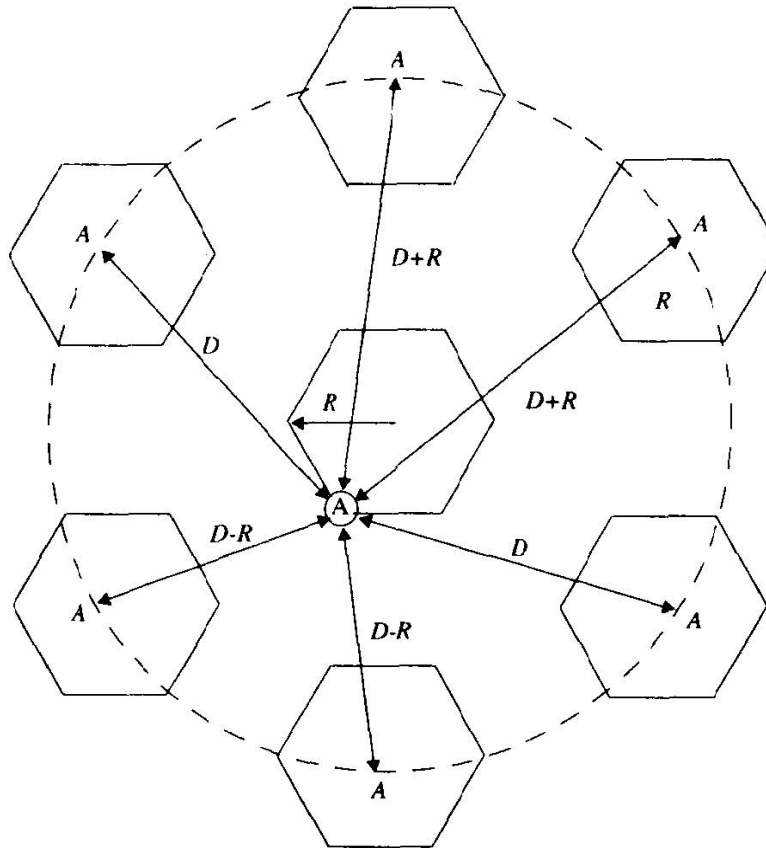


Figure 2.5

Illustration of the first tier of co-channel cells for a cluster size of $N=7$. When the mobile is at the cell boundary (point A), it experiences worst case co-channel interference on the forward channel. The marked distances between the mobile and different co-channel cells are based on approximations made for easy analysis.

2.5.2 Adjacent Channel Interference

Interference resulting from signals which are adjacent in frequency to the desired signal is called *adjacent channel interference*. Adjacent channel interference results from imperfect receiver filters which allow nearby frequencies to leak into the passband. The problem can be particularly serious if an adjacent channel user is transmitting in very close range to a subscriber's receiver, while the receiver attempts to receive a base station on the desired channel. This is referred to as the *near-far* effect, where a nearby transmitter (which may or may

not be of the same type as that used by the cellular system) captures the receiver of the subscriber. Alternatively, the near-far effect occurs when a mobile close to a base station transmits on a channel close to one being used by a weak mobile. The base station may have difficulty in discriminating the desired mobile user from the “bleedover” caused by the close adjacent channel mobile.

Adjacent channel interference can be minimized through careful filtering and channel assignments. Since each cell is given only a fraction of the available channels, a cell need not be assigned channels which are all adjacent in frequency. By keeping the frequency separation between each channel in a given cell as large as possible, the adjacent channel interference may be reduced considerably. Thus instead of assigning channels which form a contiguous band of frequencies within a particular cell, channels are allocated such that the frequency separation between channels in a given cell is maximized. By sequentially assigning successive channels in the frequency band to different cells, many channel allocation schemes are able to separate adjacent channels in a cell by as many as N channel bandwidths, where N is the cluster size. Some channel allocation schemes also prevent a secondary source of adjacent channel interference by avoiding the use of adjacent channels in neighboring cell sites.

If the frequency reuse factor is small, the separation between adjacent channels may not be sufficient to keep the adjacent channel interference level within tolerable limits. For example, if a mobile is 20 times as close to the base station as another mobile and has energy spill out of its passband, the signal-to-interference ratio for the weak mobile (before receiver filtering) is approximately

$$\frac{S}{I} = (20)^{-n} \quad (2.12)$$

For a path loss exponent $n = 4$, this is equal to -52 dB. If the intermediate frequency (IF) filter of the base station receiver has a slope of 20 dB/octave, then an adjacent channel interferer must be displaced by at least six times the passband bandwidth from the center of the receiver frequency passband to achieve 52 dB attenuation. Here, a separation of approximately six channel bandwidths is required for typical filters in order to provide 0 dB SIR from a close-in adjacent channel user. This implies that a channel separation greater than six is needed to bring the adjacent channel interference to an acceptable level, or tighter base station filters are needed when close-in and distant users share the same cell. In practice, each base station receiver is preceded by a high Q cavity filter in order to reject adjacent channel interference.

Example 2.3

This example illustrates how channels are divided into subsets and allocated to different cells so that adjacent channel interference is minimized. The United States AMPS system initially operated with 666 duplex channels. In

1989, the FCC allocated an additional 10 MHz of spectrum for cellular services, and this allowed 166 new channels to be added to the AMPS system. There are now 832 channels used in AMPS. The forward channel (870.030 MHz) along with the corresponding reverse channel (825.030 MHz) is numbered as channel 1. Similarly the forward channel 889.98 MHz along with the reverse channel 844.98 MHz is numbered as channel 666 (see Figure 1.2). The extended band has channels numbered as 667 through 799, and 990 through 1023.

In order to encourage competition, the FCC licensed the channels to two competing operators in every service area, and each operator received half of the total channels. The channels used by the two operators are distinguished as *block A* and *block B* channels. Block B is operated by companies which have traditionally provided telephone services (called *wireline operators*), and Block A is operated by companies that have not traditionally provided telephone services (called *nonwireline operators*).

Out of the 416 channels used by each operator, 395 are voice channels and the remaining 21 are control channels. Channels 1 through 312 (voice channels) and channels 313 through 333 (control channels) are block A channels, and channels 355 through 666 (voice channels) and channels 334 through 354 (control channels) are block B channels. Channels 667 through 716 and 991 through 1023 are the extended Block A voice channels, and channels 717 through 799 are extended Block B voice channels.

Each of the 395 voice channels are divided into 21 subsets, each containing about 19 channels. In each subset, the closest adjacent channel is 21 channels away. In a 7-cell reuse system, each cell uses 3 subsets of channels. The 3 subsets are assigned such that every channel in the cell is assured of being separated from every other channel by at least 7 channel spacings. This channel assignment scheme is illustrated in Table 2.2. As seen in Table 2.2, each cell uses channels in the subsets, $iA + iB + iC$, where i is an integer from 1 to 7. The total number of voice channels in a cell is about 57. The channels listed in the upper half of the chart belong to block A and those in the lower half belong to block B. The shaded set of numbers correspond to the control channels which are standard to all cellular systems in North America.

2.5.3 Power Control for Reducing Interference

In practical cellular radio and personal communication systems the power levels transmitted by every subscriber unit are under constant control by the serving base stations. This is done to ensure that each mobile transmits the smallest power necessary to maintain a good quality link on the reverse channel. Power control not only helps prolong battery life for the subscriber unit, but also dramatically reduces the reverse channel S/I in the system. As shown in Chapters 8 and 10, power control is especially important for emerging CDMA spread spectrum systems that allow every user in every cell to share the same radio channel.

Table 2.2 AMPS channel allocation for A side and B side carriers

Channel allocation chart for the 832 channel AMPS system																					
1A	2A	3A	4A	5A	6A	7A	1B	2B	3B	4B	5B	6B	7B	1C	2C	3C	4C	5C	6C	7C	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	
22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	
43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60	61	62	63	
64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	
85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	100	101	102	103	104	105	
106	107	108	109	110	111	112	113	114	115	116	117	118	119	120	121	122	123	124	125	126	
127	128	129	130	131	132	133	134	135	136	137	138	139	140	141	142	143	144	145	146	147	
148	149	150	151	152	153	154	155	156	157	158	159	160	161	162	163	164	165	166	167	168	
169	170	171	172	173	174	175	176	177	178	179	180	181	182	183	184	185	186	187	188	189	
190	191	192	193	194	195	196	197	198	199	200	201	202	203	204	205	206	207	208	209	210	
211	212	213	214	215	216	217	218	219	220	221	222	223	224	225	226	227	228	229	230	231	
232	233	234	235	236	237	238	239	240	241	242	243	244	245	246	247	248	249	250	251	252	
253	254	255	256	257	258	259	260	261	262	263	264	265	266	267	268	269	270	271	272	273	
274	275	276	277	278	279	280	281	282	283	284	285	286	287	288	289	290	291	292	293	294	
295	296	297	298	299	300	301	302	303	304	305	306	307	308	309	310	311	312	-	-	-	
313	314	315	316	317	318	319	320	321	322	323	324	325	326	327	328	329	330	331	332	333	
-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	667	668	669	
670	671	672	673	674	675	676	677	678	679	680	681	682	683	684	685	686	687	688	689	690	
691	692	693	694	695	696	697	698	699	700	701	702	703	704	705	706	707	708	709	710	711	
712	713	714	715	716	-	-	-	-	997	992	993	994	995	996	997	998	999	1000	1001	1002	
1003	1004	1005	1006	1007	1008	1009	1010	1011	1012	1013	1014	1015	1016	1017	1018	1019	1020	1021	1022	1023	
334	335	336	337	338	339	340	341	342	343	344	345	346	347	348	349	350	351	352	353	354	
355	356	357	358	359	360	361	362	363	364	365	366	367	368	369	370	371	372	373	374	375	
376	377	378	379	380	381	382	383	384	385	386	387	388	389	390	391	392	393	394	395	396	
397	398	399	400	401	402	403	404	405	406	407	408	409	410	411	412	413	414	415	416	417	
418	419	420	421	422	423	424	425	426	427	428	429	430	431	432	433	434	435	436	437	438	
439	440	441	442	443	444	445	446	447	448	449	450	451	452	453	454	455	456	457	458	459	
460	461	462	463	464	465	466	467	468	469	470	471	472	473	474	475	476	477	478	479	480	
481	482	483	484	485	486	487	488	489	490	491	492	493	494	495	496	497	498	499	500	501	
502	503	504	505	506	507	508	509	510	511	512	513	514	515	516	517	518	519	520	521	522	
523	524	525	526	527	528	529	530	531	532	533	534	535	536	537	538	539	540	541	542	543	
544	545	546	547	548	549	550	551	552	553	554	555	556	557	558	559	560	561	562	563	564	
565	566	567	568	569	570	571	572	573	574	575	576	577	578	579	580	581	582	583	584	585	
586	587	588	589	590	591	592	593	594	595	596	597	598	599	600	601	602	603	604	605	606	
607	608	609	610	611	612	613	614	615	616	617	618	619	620	621	622	623	624	625	626	627	
628	629	630	631	632	633	634	635	636	637	638	639	640	641	642	643	644	645	646	647	648	
649	650	651	652	653	654	655	656	657	658	659	660	661	662	663	664	665	666	667	668	669	
-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	720	721	722	723	724	725	726	727	728	729	730	731	732	
733	734	735	736	737	738	739	740	741	742	743	744	745	746	747	748	749	750	751	752	753	
754	755	756	757	758	759	760	761	762	763	764	765	766	767	768	769	770	771	772	773	774	
775	776	777	778	779	780	781	782	783	784	785	786	787	788	789	790	791	792	793	794	795	
796	797	798	799	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	

2.6 Trunking and Grade of Service

Cellular radio systems rely on *trunking* to accommodate a large number of users in a limited radio spectrum. The concept of trunking allows a large number of users to share the relatively small number of channels in a cell by providing access to each user, on demand, from a pool of available channels. In a trunked radio system, each user is allocated a channel on a per call basis, and upon termination of the call, the previously occupied channel is immediately returned to the pool of available channels.

Trunking exploits the statistical behavior of users so that a fixed number of channels or circuits may accommodate a large, random user community. The telephone company uses trunking theory to determine the number of telephone

circuits that need to be allocated for office buildings with hundreds of telephones, and this same principle is used in designing cellular radio systems. There is a trade-off between the number of available telephone circuits and the likelihood of a particular user finding that no circuits are available during the peak calling time. As the number of phone lines decreases, it becomes more likely that all circuits will be busy for a particular user. In a trunked mobile radio system, when a particular user requests service and all of the radio channels are already in use, the user is blocked, or denied access to the system. In some systems, a queue may be used to hold the requesting users until a channel becomes available.

To design trunked radio systems that can handle a specific capacity at a specific “grade of service”, it is essential to understand trunking theory and queuing theory. The fundamentals of trunking theory were developed by Erlang, a Danish mathematician who, in the late 19th century, embarked on the study of how a large population could be accommodated by a limited number of servers [Bou88]. Today, the measure of traffic intensity bears his name. One Erlang represents the amount of traffic intensity carried by a channel that is completely occupied (i.e. 1 call-hour per hour or 1 call-minute per minute). For example, a radio channel that is occupied for thirty minutes during an hour carries 0.5 Erlangs of traffic.

The *grade of service (GOS)* is a measure of the ability of a user to access a trunked system during the busiest hour. The busy hour is based upon customer demand at the busiest hour during a week, month, or year. The busy hours for cellular radio systems typically occur during rush hours, between 4 p.m. and 6 p.m. on a Thursday or Friday evening. The *grade of service* is a benchmark used to define the desired performance of a particular trunked system by specifying a desired likelihood of a user obtaining channel access given a specific number of channels available in the system. It is the wireless designer’s job to estimate the maximum required capacity and to allocate the proper number of channels in order to meet the *GOS*. *GOS* is typically given as the likelihood that a call is blocked, or the likelihood of a call experiencing a delay greater than a certain queuing time.

A number of definitions listed in Table 2.3 are used in trunking theory to make capacity estimates in trunked systems.

The traffic intensity offered by each user is equal to the call request rate multiplied by the holding time. That is, each user generates a traffic intensity of A_u Erlangs given by

$$A_u = \lambda H \quad (2.13)$$

where H is the average duration of a call and λ is the average number of call requests per unit time. For a system containing U users and an unspecified number of channels, the total offered traffic intensity A , is given as

$$A = UA_u \quad (2.14)$$

Table 2.3 Definitions of Common Terms Used in Trunking Theory

Set-up Time: The time required to allocate a trunked radio channel to a requesting user.
Blocked Call: Call which cannot be completed at time of request, due to congestion. Also referred to as a <i>lost call</i> .
Holding Time: Average duration of a typical call. Denoted by H (in seconds).
Traffic Intensity: Measure of channel time utilization, which is the average channel occupancy measured in Erlangs. This is a dimensionless quantity and may be used to measure the time utilization of single or multiple channels. Denoted by A .
Load: Traffic intensity across the entire trunked radio system, measured in Erlangs.
Grade of Service (GOS): A measure of congestion which is specified as the probability of a call being blocked (for Erlang B), or the probability of a call being delayed beyond a certain amount of time (for Erlang C).
Request Rate: The average number of call requests per unit time. Denoted by λ seconds ⁻¹ .

Furthermore, in a C channel trunked system, if the traffic is equally distributed among the channels, then the traffic intensity per channel, A_c , is given as

$$A_c = UA_u/C \quad (2.15)$$

Note that the offered traffic is not necessarily the traffic which is *carried* by the trunked system, only that which is *offered* to the trunked system. When the offered traffic exceeds the maximum capacity of the system, the carried traffic becomes limited due to the limited capacity (i.e. limited number of channels). The maximum possible carried traffic is the total number of channels, C , in Erlangs. The AMPS cellular system is designed for a GOS of 2% blocking. This implies that the channel allocations for cell sites are designed so that 2 out of 100 calls will be blocked due to channel occupancy during the busiest hour.

There are two types of trunked systems which are commonly used. The first type offers no queuing for call requests. That is, for every user who requests service, it is assumed there is no setup time and the user is given immediate access to a channel if one is available. If no channels are available, the requesting user is blocked without access and is free to try again later. This type of trunking is called *blocked calls cleared* and assumes that calls arrive as determined by a Poisson distribution. Furthermore, it is assumed that there are an infinite number of users as well as the following: (a) there are memoryless arrivals of requests, implying that all users, including blocked users, may request a channel at any time; (b) the probability of a user occupying a channel is exponentially distributed, so that longer calls are less likely to occur as described by an exponential distribution; and (c) there are a finite number of channels available in the trunking pool. This is known as an M/M/m queue, and leads to the derivation of the Erlang B formula (also known as the *blocked calls cleared* formula). The Erlang B formula determines the probability that a call is blocked and is a measure of the GOS for a trunked system which provides no queuing for blocked calls. The Erlang B formula is derived in Appendix A and is given by

$$Pr[\text{blocking}] = \frac{\frac{A^C}{C!}}{\sum_{k=0}^C \frac{A^k}{k!}} = GOS \quad (2.16)$$

where C is the number of trunked channels offered by a trunked radio system and A is the total offered traffic. While it is possible to model trunked systems with finite users, the resulting expressions are much more complicated than the Erlang B result, and the added complexity is not warranted for typical trunked systems which have users that outnumber available channels by orders of magnitude. Furthermore, the Erlang B formula provides a conservative estimate of the GOS, as the finite user results always predict a smaller likelihood of blocking. The capacity of a trunked radio system where blocked calls are lost is tabulated for various values of GOS and numbers of channels in Table 2.4.

Table 2.4 Capacity of an Erlang B System

Number of Channels C	Capacity (Erlangs) for GOS			
	= 0.01	= 0.005	= 0.002	= 0.001
2	0.153	0.105	0.065	0.046
4	0.869	0.701	0.535	0.439
5	1.36	1.13	0.900	0.762
10	4.46	3.96	3.43	3.09
20	12.0	11.1	10.1	9.41
24	15.3	14.2	13.0	12.2
40	29.0	27.3	25.7	24.5
70	56.1	53.7	51.0	49.2
100	84.1	80.9	77.4	75.2

The second kind of trunked system is one in which a queue is provided to hold calls which are blocked. If a channel is not available immediately, the call request may be delayed until a channel becomes available. This type of trunking is called *Blocked Calls Delayed*, and its measure of GOS is defined as the probability that a call is blocked after waiting a specific length of time in the queue. To find the GOS, it is first necessary to find the likelihood that a call is initially denied access to the system. The likelihood of a call not having immediate access to a channel is determined by the Erlang C formula derived in Appendix A

$$Pr[\text{delay} > 0] = \frac{A^C}{A^C + C! \left(1 - \frac{A}{C}\right) \sum_{k=0}^{C-1} \frac{A^k}{k!}} \quad (2.17)$$

If no channels are immediately available the call is delayed, and the probability that the delayed call is forced to wait more than t seconds is given by the probability that a call is delayed, multiplied by the conditional probability that the delay is greater than t seconds. The GOS of a trunked system where blocked calls are delayed is hence given by

$$\begin{aligned} Pr[\text{delay} > t] &= Pr[\text{delay} > 0] Pr[\text{delay} > t | \text{delay} > 0] \\ &= Pr[\text{delay} > 0] \exp(-(C-A)t/H) \end{aligned} \quad (2.18)$$

The average delay D for all calls in a queued system is given by

$$D = Pr[\text{delay} > 0] \frac{H}{C-A} \quad (2.19)$$

where the average delay for those calls which are queued is given by $H/(C-A)$.

The Erlang B and Erlang C formulas are plotted in graphical form in Figure 2.6 and Figure 2.7. These graphs are useful for determining GOS in rapid fashion, although computer simulations are often used to determine transient behaviors experienced by particular users in a mobile system.

To use Figure 2.6 and Figure 2.7, locate the number of channels on the top portion of the graph. Locate the traffic intensity of the system on the bottom portion of the graph. The blocking probability $Pr[\text{blocking}]$ is shown on the abscissa of Figure 2.6, and $Pr[\text{delay} > 0]$ is shown on the abscissa of Figure 2.7. With two of the parameters specified it is easy to find the third parameter.

Example 2.4

How many users can be supported for 0.5% blocking probability for the following number of trunked channels in a blocked calls cleared system? (a) 1, (b) 5, (c) 10, (d) 20, (e) 100. Assume each user generates 0.1 Erlangs of traffic.

Solution to Example 2.4

From Table 2.4 we can find the total capacity in Erlangs for the 0.5% GOS for different numbers of channels. By using the relation $A = UA_u$, we can obtain the total number of users that can be supported in the system.

(a) Given $C = 1$, $A_u = 0.1$, $GOS = 0.005$

From Figure 2.6, we obtain $A = 0.005$.

Therefore, total number of users, $U = A/A_u = 0.005/0.1 = 0.05$ users.

But, actually one user could be supported on one channel. So, $U = 1$.

(b) Given $C = 5$, $A_u = 0.1$, $GOS = 0.005$

From Figure 2.6, we obtain $A = 1.13$.

Therefore, total number of users, $U = A/A_u = 1.13/0.1 \approx 11$ users.

(c) Given $C = 10$, $A_u = 0.1$, $GOS = 0.005$

From Figure 2.6, we obtain $A = 3.96$.

Therefore, total number of users, $U = A/A_u = 3.96/0.1 \approx 39$ users.

(d) Given $C = 20$, $A_u = 0.1$, $GOS = 0.005$

From Figure 2.6, we obtain $A = 11.10$.

Therefore, total number of users, $U = A/A_u = 11.1/0.1 = 110$ users.

(e) Given $C = 100$, $A_u = 0.1$, $GOS = 0.005$

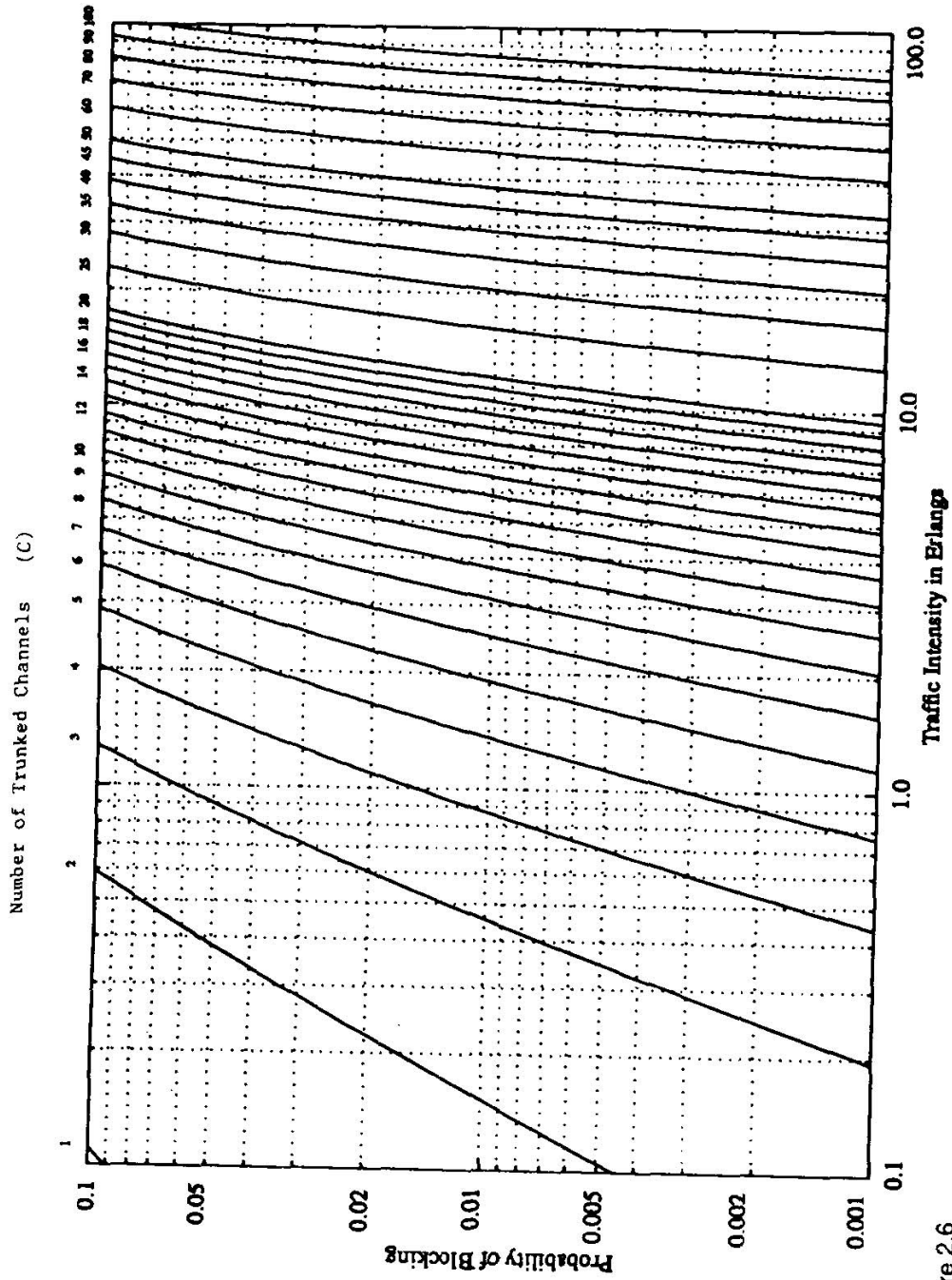


Figure 2.6
The Erlang B chart showing the probability of blocking as functions of the number of channels and traffic intensity in Erlangs.

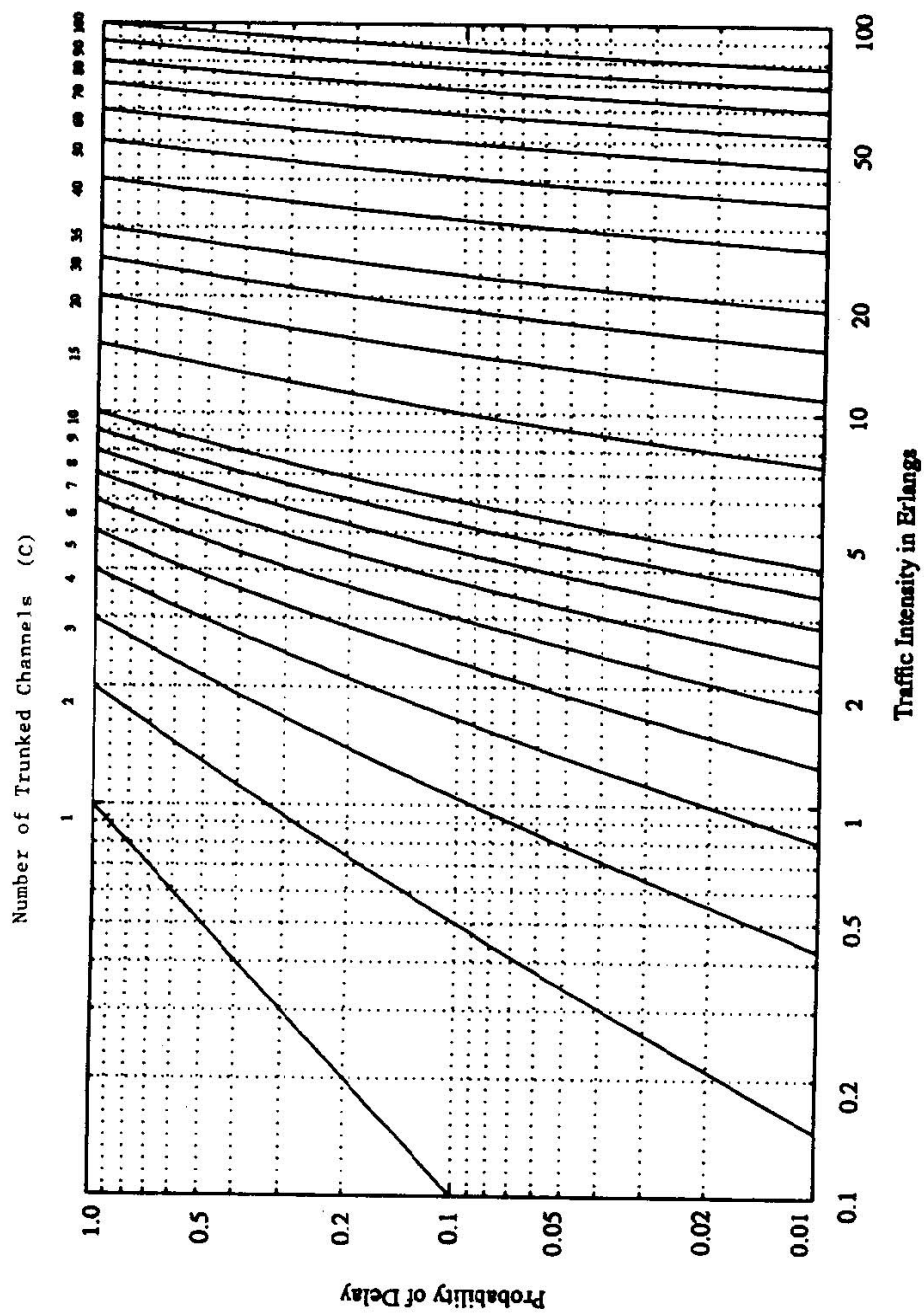


Figure 2.7
The Erlang C chart showing the probability of a call being delayed as a function of the number of channels and traffic intensity in Erlangs.

From Figure 2.6, we obtain $A = 80.9$.

Therefore, total number of users, $U = A/A_u = 80.9/0.1 = 809$ users.

Example 2.5

An urban area has a population of 2 million residents. Three competing trunked mobile networks (systems A, B, and C) provide cellular service in this area. System A has 394 cells with 19 channels each, system B has 98 cells with 57 channels each, and system C has 49 cells, each with 100 channels. Find the number of users that can be supported at 2% blocking if each user averages 2 calls per hour at an average call duration of 3 minutes. Assuming that all three trunked systems are operated at maximum capacity, compute the percentage market penetration of each cellular provider.

Solution to Example 2.5

System A

Given:

Probability of blocking = 2% = 0.02

Number of channels per cell used in the system, $C = 19$

Traffic intensity per user, $A_u = \lambda H = 2 \times (3/60) = 0.1$ Erlangs

For $GOS = 0.02$ and $C = 19$, from the Erlang B chart, the total carried traffic, A , is obtained as 12 Erlangs.

Therefore, the number of users that can be supported per cell is

$$U = A/A_u = 12/0.1 = 120.$$

Since there are 394 cells, the total number of subscribers that can be supported by System A is equal to $120 \times 394 = 47280$.

System B

Given:

Probability of blocking = 2% = 0.02

Number of channels per cell used in the system, $C = 57$

Traffic intensity per user, $A_u = \lambda H = 2 \times (3/60) = 0.1$ Erlangs

For $GOS = 0.02$ and $C = 57$, from the Erlang B chart, the total carried traffic, A , is obtained as 45 Erlangs.

Therefore, the number of users that can be supported per cell is

$$U = A/A_u = 45/0.1 = 450.$$

Since there are 98 cells, the total number of subscribers that can be supported by System B is equal to $450 \times 98 = 44100$.

System C

Given:

Probability of blocking = 2% = 0.02

Number of channels per cell used in the system, $C = 100$

Traffic intensity per user, $A_u = \lambda H = 2 \times (3/60) = 0.1$ Erlangs

For $GOS = 0.02$ and $C = 100$, from the Erlang B chart, the total carried traffic, A , is obtained as 88 Erlangs.

Therefore, the number of users that can be supported per cell is

$$U = A/A_u = 88/0.1 = 880.$$

Since there are 49 cells, the total number of subscribers that can be supported by System C is equal to $880 \times 49 = 43120$.
Therefore, total number of cellular subscribers that can be supported by these three systems are $47280 + 44100 + 43120 = 134500$ users.

Since there are 2 million residents in the given urban area and the total number of cellular subscribers in System A is equal to 47280, the percentage market penetration is equal to

$$47280/2000000 = 2.36 \%$$

Similarly, market penetration of System B is equal to

$$44100/2000000 = 2.205 \%$$

and the market penetration of System C is equal to

$$43120/2000000 = 2.156 \%$$

The market penetration of the three systems combined is equal to

$$134500/2000000 = 6.725 \%$$

Example 2.6

A certain city has an area of 1,300 square miles and is covered by a cellular system using a 7-cell reuse pattern. Each cell has a radius of 4 miles and the city is allocated 40 MHz of spectrum with a full duplex channel bandwidth of 60 kHz. Assume a GOS of 2% for an Erlang B system is specified. If the offered traffic per user is 0.03 Erlangs, compute (a) the number of cells in the service area, (b) the number of channels per cell, (c) traffic intensity of each cell, (d) the maximum carried traffic, (e) the total number of users that can be served for 2% GOS, (f) the number of mobiles per channel, and (g) the theoretical maximum number of users that could be served at one time by the system.

Solution to Example 2.6

(a) Given:

Total coverage area = 1300 miles

Cell radius = 4 miles

The area of a cell (hexagon) can be shown to be $2.5981R^2$, thus each cell covers

$$2.5981 \times (4)^2 = 41.57 \text{ sq mi.}$$

Hence, the total number of cells are $N_c = 1300/41.57 = 31$ cells.

(b) The total number of channels per cell (C)

= allocated spectrum / (channel width $\times$ frequency reuse factor)

$$= 40,000,000 / (60,000 \times 7) = 95 \text{ channels/cell}$$

(c) Given:

$C = 95$, and $GOS = 0.02$

From the Erlang B chart, we have

traffic intensity per cell $A = 84$ Erlangs/cell

(d) Maximum carried traffic = number of cells $\times$ traffic intensity per cell

$$= 31 \times 84 = 2604 \text{ Erlangs.}$$

(e) Given traffic per user = 0.03 Erlangs

Total number of users = Total traffic / traffic per user

$$= 2604 / 0.03 = 86,800 \text{ users.}$$

- (f) Number of mobiles per channel = number of users/number of channels
 $= 86,800 / 666 = 130 \text{ mobiles/channel.}$

- (g) The theoretical maximum number of served mobiles is the number of available channels in the system (all channels occupied)
 $= C \times N_C = 95 \times 31 = 2945 \text{ users, which is 3.4\% of the customer base.}$

Example 2.7

A hexagonal cell within a 4-cell system has a radius of 1.387 km. A total of 60 channels are used within the entire system. If the load per user is 0.029 Erlangs, and $\lambda = 1$ call/hour, compute the following for an Erlang C system that has a 5% probability of a delayed call:

- (a) How many users per square kilometer will this system support?
 (a) What is the probability that a delayed call will have to wait for more than 10 s?
 (c) What is the probability that a call will be delayed for more than 10 seconds?

Solution to Example 2.7

Given,

Cell radius, $R = 1.387 \text{ km}$

Area covered per cell is $2.598 \times (1.387)^2 = 5 \text{ sq km}$

Number of cells per cluster = 4

Total number of channels = 60

Therefore, number of channels per cell = $60 / 4 = 15 \text{ channels.}$

- (a) From Erlang C chart, for 5% probability of delay with $C = 15$, traffic intensity = 9.0 Erlangs.

Therefore, number of users = total traffic intensity / traffic per user

$$= 9.0 / 0.029 = 310 \text{ users}$$

$$= 310 \text{ users} / 5 \text{ sq km} = 62 \text{ users/sq km}$$

- (b) Given $\lambda = 1$, holding time

$$H = A_u / \lambda = 0.029 \text{ hour} = 104.4 \text{ seconds.}$$

The probability that a delayed call will have to wait for more than 10 s is

$$\begin{aligned} Pr[\text{delay} > t | \text{delay}] &= \exp(-(C - A)t / H) \\ &= \exp(-(15 - 9.0)10 / 104.4) = 56.29 \% \end{aligned}$$

- (c) Given $Pr[\text{delay} > 0] = 5\% = 0.05$

Probability that a call is delayed more than 10 seconds,

$$\begin{aligned} Pr[\text{delay} > 10] &= Pr[\text{delay} > 0] Pr[\text{delay} > t | \text{delay}] \\ &= 0.05 \times 0.5629 = 2.81 \% \end{aligned}$$

Trunking efficiency is a measure of the number of users which can be offered a particular GOS with a particular configuration of fixed channels. The way in which channels are grouped can substantially alter the number of users handled by a trunked system. For example, from Table 2.4, 10 trunked channels at a GOS of 0.01 can support 4.46 Erlangs of traffic, whereas 2 groups of 5 trunked channels can support 2×1.36 Erlangs, or 2.72 Erlangs of traffic.

Clearly, 10 channels trunked together support 60% more traffic at a specific GOS than do two 5 channel trunks! It should be clear that the allocation of channels in a trunked radio system has a major impact on overall system capacity.

2.7 Improving Capacity in Cellular Systems

As the demand for wireless service increases, the number of channels assigned to a cell eventually becomes insufficient to support the required number of users. At this point, cellular design techniques are needed to provide more channels per unit coverage area. Techniques such as *cell splitting*, *sectoring*, and *coverage zone approaches* are used in practice to expand the capacity of cellular systems. Cell splitting allows an orderly growth of the cellular system. Sectoring uses directional antennas to further control the interference and frequency reuse of channels. The *zone microcell* concept distributes the coverage of a cell and extends the cell boundary to hard-to-reach places. While cell splitting increases the number of base stations in order to increase capacity, sectoring and zone microcells rely on base station antenna placements to improve capacity by reducing co-channel interference. Cell splitting and zone microcell techniques do not suffer the trunking inefficiencies experienced by sectorized cells, and enable the base station to oversee all handoff chores related to the microcells, thus reducing the computational load at the MSC. These three popular capacity improvement techniques will be explained in detail.

2.7.1 Cell Splitting

Cell splitting is the process of subdividing a congested cell into smaller cells, each with its own base station and a corresponding reduction in antenna height and transmitter power. Cell splitting increases the capacity of a cellular system since it increases the number of times that channels are reused. By defining new cells which have a smaller radius than the original cells and by installing these smaller cells (called *microcells*) between the existing cells, capacity increases due to the additional number of channels per unit area.

Imagine if every cell in Figure 2.1 were reduced in such a way that the radius of every cell was cut in half. In order to cover the entire service area with smaller cells, approximately four times as many cells would be required. This can be easily shown by considering a circle with radius R . The area covered by such a circle is four times as large as the area covered by a circle with radius $R/2$. The increased number of cells would increase the number of clusters over the coverage region, which in turn would increase the number of channels, and thus capacity, in the coverage area. Cell splitting allows a system to grow by replacing large cells with smaller cells, while not upsetting the channel allocation scheme required to maintain the minimum co-channel reuse ratio Q (see equation (2.4)) between co-channel cells.

An example of cell splitting is shown in Figure 2.8. In Figure 2.8, the base stations are placed at corners of the cells, and the area served by base station A is assumed to be saturated with traffic (i.e., the blocking of base station A exceeds acceptable rates). New base stations are therefore needed in the region to increase the number of channels in the area and to reduce the area served by the single base station. Note in the figure that the original base station A has been surrounded by six new microcell base stations. In the example shown in Figure 2.8, the smaller cells were added in such a way as to preserve the frequency reuse plan of the system. For example, the microcell base station labeled G was placed half way between two larger stations utilizing the same channel set G. This is also the case for the other microcells in the figure. As can be seen from Figure 2.8, cell splitting merely scales the geometry of the cluster. In this case, the radius of each new microcell is half that of the original cell.

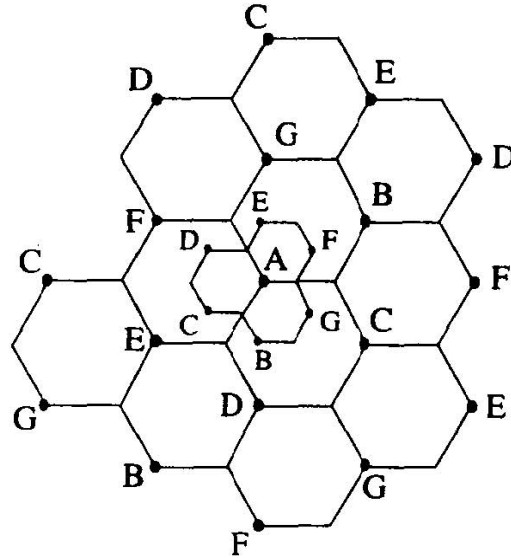


Figure 2.8
Illustration of cell splitting.

For the new cells to be smaller in size, the transmit power of these cells must be reduced. The transmit power of the new cells with radius half that of the original cells can be found by examining the received power P_r at the new and old cell boundaries and setting them equal to each other. This is necessary to ensure that the frequency reuse plan for the new microcells behaves exactly as for the original cells. For Figure 2.8

$$P_r[\text{at old cell boundary}] \propto P_{t1} R^{-n} \quad (2.20)$$

and

$$P_r[\text{at new cell boundary}] \propto P_{t2} (R/2)^{-n} \quad (2.21)$$

where P_{t1} and P_{t2} are the transmit powers of the larger and smaller cell base stations, respectively, and n is the path loss exponent. If we take $n = 4$ and set the received powers equal to each other, then

$$P_{t2} = \frac{P_{t1}}{16} \quad (2.22)$$

In other words, the transmit power must be reduced by 12 dB in order to fill in the original coverage area with microcells, while maintaining the S/I requirement.

In practice, not all cells are split at the same time. It is often difficult for service providers to find real estate that is perfectly situated for cell splitting. Therefore, different cell sizes will exist simultaneously. In such situations, special care needs to be taken to keep the distance between co-channel cells at the required minimum, and hence channel assignments become more complicated [Rap97]. Also, handoff issues must be addressed so that high speed and low speed traffic can be simultaneously accommodated (the umbrella cell approach of Section 2.4 is commonly used). When there are two cell sizes in the same region as shown in Figure 2.8, equation (2.22) shows that one can not simply use the original transmit power for all new cells or the new transmit power for all the original cells. If the larger transmit power is used for all cells, some channels used by the smaller cells would not be sufficiently separated from co-channel cells. On the other hand, if the smaller transmit power is used for all the cells, there would be parts of the larger cells left unserved. For this reason, channels in the old cell must be broken down into two channel groups, one that corresponds to the smaller cell reuse requirements and the other that corresponds to the larger cell reuse requirements. The larger cell is usually dedicated to high speed traffic so that handoffs occur less frequently.

The two channel group sizes depend on the stage of the splitting process. At the beginning of the cell splitting process there will be fewer channels in the small power groups. However, as demand grows, more channels will be required, and thus the smaller groups will require more channels. This splitting process continues until all the channels in an area are used in the lower power group, at which point cell splitting is complete within the region, and the entire system is rescaled to have a smaller radius per cell. *Antenna downtilting*, which deliberately focuses radiated energy from the base station towards the ground (rather than towards the horizon), is often used to limit the radio coverage of newly formed microcells.

Example 2.8

Consider Figure 2.9. Assume each base station uses 60 channels, regardless of cell size. If each original cell has a radius of 1 km and each microcell has a radius of 0.5 km, find the number of channels contained in a 3 km by 3 km

square centered around A, (a) without the use of microcells, (b) when the lettered microcells as shown in Figure 2.9 are used, and (c) if all the original base stations are replaced by microcells. Assume cells on the edge of the square to be contained within the square.

Solution to Example 2.8

(a) without the use of microcells:

A cell radius of 1 km implies that the sides of the larger hexagons are also 1 km in length. To cover the 3 km by 3 km square centered around base station A, we need to cover 1.5 km (1.5 times the hexagon radius) towards the right, left, top, and bottom of base station A. This is shown in Figure 2.9. From Figure 2.9 we see that this area contains 5 base stations. Since each base station has 60 channels, the total number of channels without cell splitting is equal to $5 \times 60 = 300$ channels.

(b) with the use of the microcells as shown in Figure 2.9:

In Figure 2.9, the base station A is surrounded by 6 microcells. Therefore, the total number of base stations in the square area under study is equal to $5 + 6 = 11$. Since each base station has 60 channels, the total number of channels will be equal to $11 \times 60 = 660$ channels. This is a 2.2 times increase in capacity when compared to case (a).

(c) if all the base stations are replaced by microcells:

From Figure 2.9, we see that there are a total of $5 + 12 = 17$ base stations in the square region under study. Since each base station has 60 channels, the total number of channels will be equal to $17 \times 60 = 1020$ channels. This is a 3.4 times increase in capacity when compared to case (a).

Theoretically, if all cells were microcells having half the radius of the original cell, the capacity increase would approach 4.

2.7.2 Sectoring

As shown in section 2.7.1, cell splitting achieves capacity improvement by essentially rescaling the system. By decreasing the cell radius R and keeping the co-channel reuse ratio D/R unchanged, cell splitting increases the number of channels per unit area. However, another way to increase capacity is to keep the cell radius unchanged and seek methods to decrease the D/R ratio. In this approach, capacity improvement is achieved by reducing the number of cells in a cluster and thus increasing the frequency reuse. However, in order to do this, it is necessary to reduce the relative interference without decreasing the transmit power.

The co-channel interference in a cellular system may be decreased by replacing a single omni-directional antenna at the base station by several directional antennas, each radiating within a specified sector. By using directional antennas, a given cell will receive interference and transmit with only a fraction

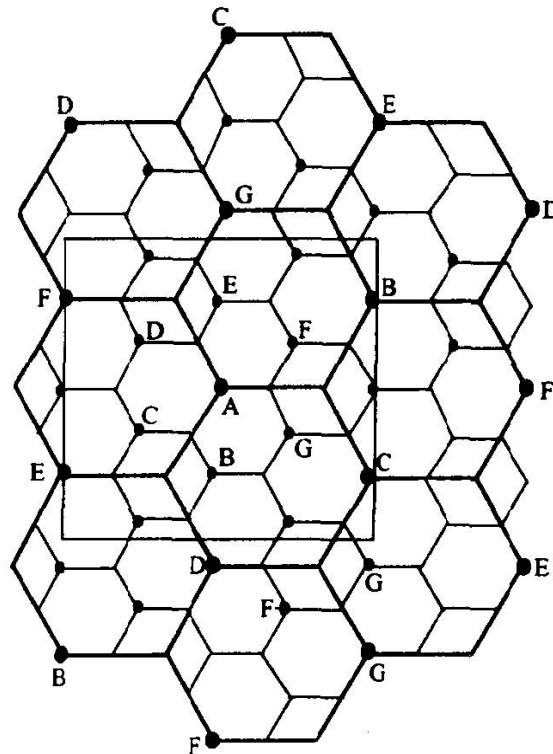


Figure 2.9

Illustration of cell splitting within a 3 km by 3 km square centered around base station A.

of the available co-channel cells. The technique for decreasing co-channel interference and thus increasing system capacity by using directional antennas is called *sectoring*. The factor by which the co-channel interference is reduced depends on the amount of sectoring used. A cell is normally partitioned into three 120° sectors or six 60° sectors as shown in Figure 2.10(a) and (b).

When sectoring is employed, the channels used in a particular cell are broken down into *sectorized groups* and are used only within a particular sector, as illustrated in Figure 2.10(a) and (b). Assuming 7-cell reuse, for the case of 120° sectors, the number of interferers in the first tier is reduced from 6 to 2. This is because only 2 of the 6 co-channel cells receive interference with a particular sectorized channel group. Referring to Figure 2.11, consider the interference experienced by a mobile located in the right-most sector in the center cell labeled "5". There are 3 co-channel cell sectors labeled "5" to the right of the center cell, and 3 to the left of the center cell. Out of these 6 co-channel cells, only 2 cells have sectors with antenna patterns which radiate into the center cell, and hence a mobile in the center cell will experience interference on the forward link from only these two sectors. The resulting S/I for this case can be found using equa-

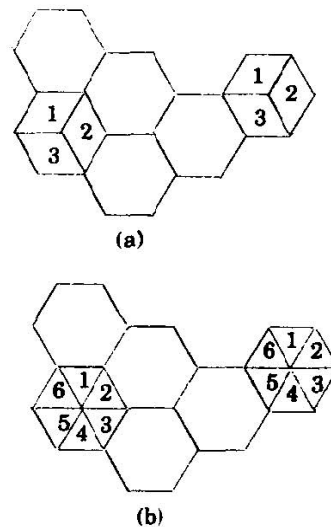


Figure 2.10
 (a) 120° sectoring.
 (b) 60° sectoring.

tion (2.8) to be 24.2 dB, which is a significant improvement over the omni-directional case in Section 2.5, where the worst case S/I was shown to be 17 dB. In practical systems, further improvement in S/I is achieved by downtilting the sector antennas such that the radiation pattern in the vertical (elevation) plane has a notch at the nearest co-channel cell distance.

The improvement in S/I implies that with 120° sectoring, the minimum required S/I of 18 dB can be easily achieved with 7-cell reuse, as compared to 12-cell reuse for the worst possible situation in the unsectorized case (see Section 2.5.1). Thus, sectoring reduces interference, which amounts to an increase in capacity by a factor of 12/7, or 1.714. In practice, the reduction in interference offered by sectoring enable planners to reduce the cluster size N , and provides an additional degree of freedom in assigning channels. The penalty for improved S/I and the resulting capacity improvement is an increased number of antennas at each base station, and a decrease in trunking efficiency due to channel sectoring at the base station. Since sectoring reduces the coverage area of a particular group of channels, the number of handoffs increases, as well. Fortunately, many modern base stations support sectorization and allow mobiles to be handed off from sector to sector within the same cell without intervention from the MSC, so the handoff problem is often not a major concern.

It is the loss of traffic due to decreased trunking efficiency that causes some operators to shy away from the sectoring approach, particularly in dense urban areas where the directional antenna patterns are somewhat ineffective in controlling radio propagation. Because sectoring uses more than one antenna per base station, the available channels in the cell must be subdivided and dedicated

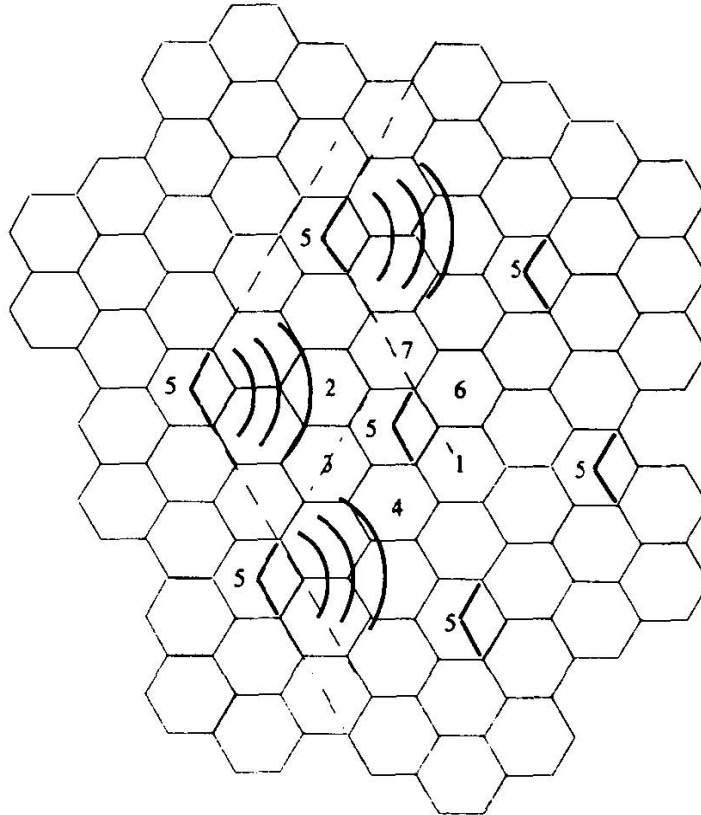


Figure 2.11

Illustration of how 120° sectoring reduces interference from co-channel cells. Out of the 6 co-channel cells in the first tier, only 2 of them interfere with the center cell. If omni-directional antennas were used at each base station, all 6 co-channel cells would interfere with the center cell.

to a specific antenna. This breaks up the available trunked channel pool into several smaller pools, and decreases trunking efficiency.

Example 2.9

Consider a cellular system in which an average call lasts 2 minutes, and the probability of blocking is to be no more than 1%. Assume that every subscriber makes 1 call per hour, on average. If there are a total of 395 traffic channels for a 7-cell reuse system, there will be about 57 traffic channels per cell. Assume that blocked calls are cleared so the blocking is described by the Erlang B distribution. From the Erlang B distribution, it can be found that the unsectored system may handle 44.2 Erlangs or 1326 calls per hour.

Now employing 120° sectoring, there are only 19 channels per antenna sector (57/3 antennas). For the same probability of blocking and average call length, it can be found from the Erlang B distribution that each sector can handle 11.2

Erlangs or 336 calls per hour. Since each cell consists of 3 sectors, this provides a cell capacity of $3 \times 336 = 1008$ calls per hour, which amounts to a 24% decrease when compared to the unsector case. Thus, sectoring decreases the trunking efficiency while improving the S/I for each user in the system.

It can be found that using 60° sectors improves the S/I even more. In this case the number of first tier interferers is reduced from 6 to only 1. This results in $S/I = 29$ dB for a 7-cell system and enables 4-cell reuse. Of course, using 6 sectors per cell reduces the trunking efficiency and increases the number of necessary handoffs even more. If the unsector case is compared to the 6 sector case, the degradation in trunking efficiency can be shown to be 44%. (The proof of this is left as an exercise).

2.7.3 A Novel Microcell Zone Concept

The increased number of handoffs required when sectoring is employed results in an increased load on the switching and control link elements of the mobile system. A solution to this problem was presented by Lee [Lee91b]. This proposal is based on a microcell concept for 7 cell reuse, as illustrated in Figure 2.12. In this scheme, each of the three (or possibly more) zone sites (represented as Tx/Rx in Figure 2.12) are connected to a single base station and share the same radio equipment. The zones are connected by coaxial cable, fiberoptic cable, or microwave link to the base station. Multiple zones and a single base station make up a cell. As a mobile travels within the cell, it is served by the zone with the strongest signal. This approach is superior to sectoring since antennas are placed at the outer edges of the cell, and any base station channel may be assigned to any zone by the base station.

As a mobile travels from one zone to another within the cell, it retains the same channel. Thus, unlike in sectoring, a handoff is not required at the MSC when the mobile travels between zones within the cell. The base station simply switches the channel to a different zone site. In this way, a given channel is active only in the particular zone in which the mobile is traveling, and hence the base station radiation is localized and interference is reduced. The channels are distributed in time and space by all three zones and are also reused in co-channel cells in the normal fashion. This technique is particularly useful along highways or along urban traffic corridors.

The advantage of the zone cell technique is that while the cell maintains a particular coverage radius, the co-channel interference in the cellular system is reduced since a large central base station is replaced by several lower powered transmitters (zone transmitters) on the edges of the cell. Decreased co-channel interference improves the signal quality and also leads to an increase in capacity, without the degradation in trunking efficiency caused by sectoring. As mentioned earlier, an S/I of 18 dB is typically required for satisfactory system performance in narrowband FM. For a system with $N = 7$, a D/R of 4.6 was

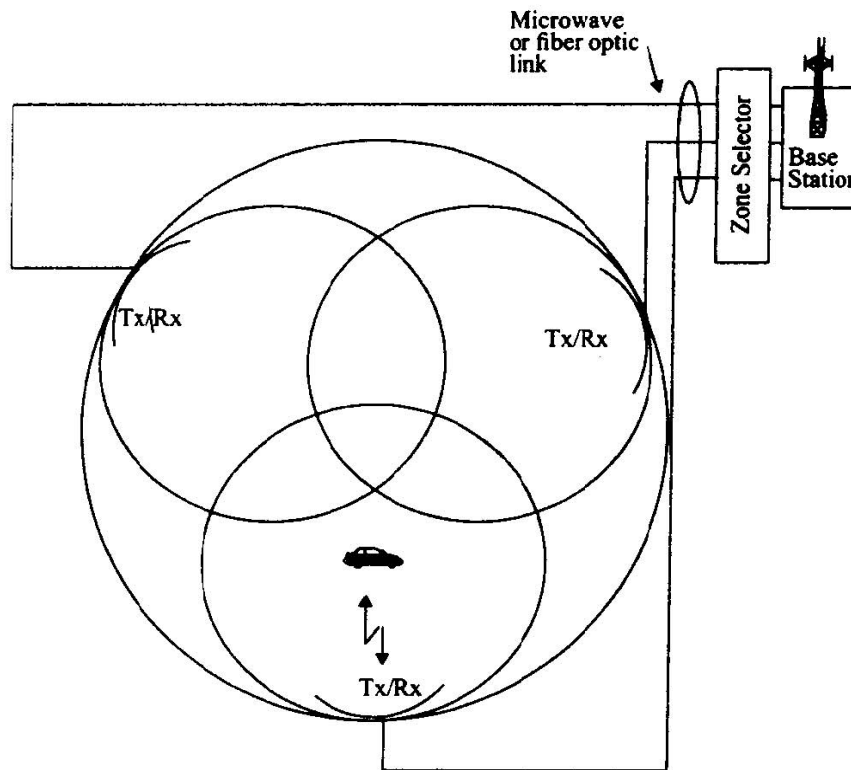


Figure 2.12

The microcell concept [adapted from [Lee91b] © IEEE].

shown to achieve this. With respect to the zone microcell system, since transmission at any instant is confined to a particular zone, this implies that a D_z/R_z of 4.6 (where D_z is the minimum distance between active co-channel zones and R_z is the zone radius) can achieve the required link performance. In Figure 2.13, let each individual hexagon represents a zone, while each group of three hexagons represents a cell. The zone radius R_z is approximately equal to one hexagon radius. Now, the capacity of the zone microcell system is directly related to the distance between co-channel cells, and not zones. This distance is represented as D in Figure 2.13. For a D_z/R_z value of 4.6, it can be seen from the geometry of Figure 2.13 that the value of co-channel reuse ratio, D/R , is equal to 3, where R is the radius of the cell and is equal to twice the length of the hexagon radius. Using equation (2.4), $D/R = 3$ corresponds to a cluster size of $N = 3$. This reduction in the cluster size from $N = 7$ to $N = 3$ amounts to a 2.33 times increase in capacity for a system completely based on the zone microcell concept. Hence for the same S/I requirement of 18 dB, this system provides a significant increase in capacity over conventional cellular planning.

By examining Figure 2.13 and using equation (2.8) [Lee91b] the exact worst case S/I of the zone microcell system can be estimated to be 20 dB. Thus, in the worst case, the system provides a margin of 2 dB over the required signal-to-interference ratio while increasing the capacity by 2.33 times over a conventional 7-cell system using omni-directional antennas. No loss in trunking efficiency is experienced. Zone cell architectures are being adopted in many cellular and personal communication systems.

2.8 Summary

In this chapter, the fundamental concepts of handoff, frequency reuse, trunking efficiency, and frequency planning have been presented. Handoffs are required to pass mobile traffic from cell to cell, and there are various ways handoffs are implemented. The capacity of a cellular system is a function of many variables. The S/I limits the frequency reuse factor of a system, which limits the number of channels within the coverage area. The trunking efficiency limits the number of users that can access a trunked radio system. Trunking is affected by the number of available channels and how they are partitioned in a trunked cellular system. Trunking efficiency is quantified by the GOS. Finally, cell splitting, sectoring, and the zone microcell technique are all shown to improve capacity by increasing S/I in some fashion. The overriding objective in all of these methods is to increase the number of users within the system. The radio propagation characteristics influence the effectiveness of all of these methods in an actual system. Radio propagation is the subject of the following two chapters.

2.9 Problems

- 2.1 Prove that for a hexagonal geometry, the co-channel reuse ratio is given by $Q = \sqrt{3N}$, where $N = i^2 + ij + j^2$. (Hint: use the cosine law and the hexagonal cell geometry).
- 2.2 Show that the frequency reuse factor for a cellular system is given by k/S , where k is the average number of channels per cell and S is the total number of channels available to the cellular service provider.
- 2.3 A cellular service provider decides to use a digital TDMA scheme which can tolerate a signal-to-interference ratio of 15 dB in the worst case. Find the optimal value of N for (a) omni-directional antennas, (b) 120° sectoring, and (c) 60° sectoring. Should sectoring be used? If so, which case (60° or 120°) should be used? (Assume a path loss exponent of $n = 4$ and consider trunking efficiency).
- 2.4 If an intensive propagation measurement campaign showed that the mobile radio channel provided a propagation path loss exponent of $n = 3$ instead of 4, how would your design decisions in Problem 2.3 change? What is the optimal value of N for the case of $n = 3$?
- 2.5 For a $N = 7$ system with a $Pr\{Blocking\} = 1\%$ and average call length of 2 minutes, find the traffic capacity loss due to trunking for 57 channels when going from omni-directional antennas to 60° sectored antennas. (Assume that blocked calls are cleared and the average per user call rate is $\lambda = 1$ per hour).

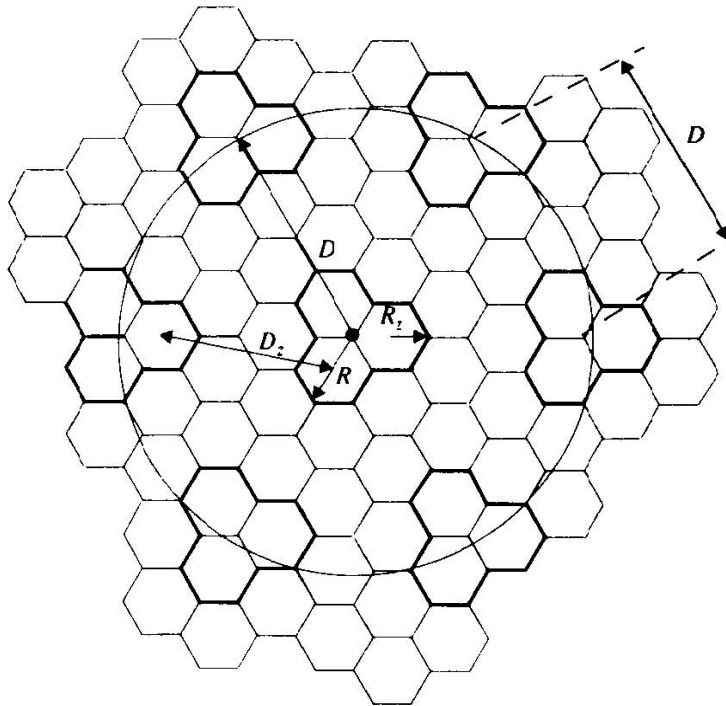


Figure 2.13

Defining D , D_z , R , R_z for a microcell architecture with $N = 7$. The smaller hexagons form zones and three hexagons (outlined in bold) together form a cell. Six nearest co-channel cells are shown.

- 2.6 Assume that a cell named “Radio Knob” has 57 channels, each with an effective radiated power of 32 watts and a cell radius of 10 km. The grade of service is established to be a probability of blocking of 5% (assuming blocked calls are cleared). Assume the average call length is 2 minutes, and each user averages 2 calls per hour. Further, assume the cell has just reached its maximum capacity and must be split into 4 new microcells to provide 4 times the capacity in the same area. (a) What is the current capacity of the “Radio Knob” cell? (b) What is the radius and transmit power of the new cells? (c) How many channels are needed in each of the new cells to maintain frequency reuse stability in the system? (d) If traffic is uniformly distributed, what is the new traffic carried by each new cell? Will the probability of blocking in these new cells be below 0.1% after the split?
- 2.7 Exercises in trunking (queueing) theory:
- What is the maximum system capacity (*total* and *per channel*) in Erlangs when providing a 2% blocking probability with 4 channels, with 20 channels, with 40 channels?
 - How many users can be supported with 40 channels at 2% blocking? Assume $H = 105$ s, $\lambda = 1$ call/hour.
 - Using the traffic intensity per channel calculated in part (a), find the grade of service in a lost call delayed system for the case of delays being greater than 20 seconds. Assume that $H = 105$ s, and determine the GOS

- for 4 channels, for 20 channels, for 40 channels.
- (d) Comparing part (a) and part (c), does a lost call delayed system with a 20 second queue perform better than a system that clears blocked calls?
- 2.8 A receiver in an urban cellular radio system detects a 1 mW signal at $d = d_0 = 1$ meter from the transmitter. In order to mitigate co-channel interference effects, it is required that the signal received at any base station receiver from another base station transmitter which operates with the same channel must be below -100 dBm. A measurement team has determined that the average path loss exponent in the system is $n = 3$. Determine the major radius of each cell if a 7-cell reuse pattern is used. What is the major radius if a 4-cell reuse pattern is used?
- 2.9 A cellular system using a cluster size of 7 is described in Problem 2.8. It is operated with 660 channels, 30 of which are designated as setup (control) channels so that there are about 90 voice channels available per cell. If there is a potential user density of 9000 users/km² in the system, and each user makes an average of one call per hour and each call lasts 1 minute during peak hours, determine the probability that a user will experience a delay greater than 20 seconds if all calls are queued.
- 2.10 Show that if $n = 4$, a cell can be split into four smaller cells, each with half the radius and 1/16 of the transmitter power of the original cell. If extensive measurements show that the path loss exponent is 3, how should the transmitter power be changed in order to split a cell into four smaller cells? What impact will this have on the cellular geometry? Explain your answer and provide drawings that show how the new cells would fit within the original macrocells. For simplicity use omni-directional antennas.
- 2.11 Using the frequency assignment chart in Table 2.2, design a channelization scheme for a B-side carrier that uses 4-cell reuse and 3 sectors per cell. Include an allocation scheme for the 21 control channels.
- 2.12 Repeat Problem 2.11 for the case of 4-cell reuse and 6 sectors per cell.
- 2.13 In practical cellular radio systems, the MSC is programmed to allocate radio channels differently for the closest co-channel cells. This technique, called a *hunting sequence*, ensures that co-channel cells first use different channels from within the co-channel set, before the same channels are assigned to calls in nearby cells. This minimizes co-channel interference when the cellular system is not fully loaded. Consider 3 adjoining clusters, and design an algorithm that may be used by the MSC to hunt for appropriate channels when requested from co-channel cells. Assume a 7-cell reuse pattern with 3 sectors per cell, and use the U.S. cellular channel allocation scheme for the A-side carrier.
- 2.14 Determine the noise floor (in dBm) for mobile receivers which implement the following standards: (a) AMPS, (b) GSM, (c) USDC, (d) DECT, (e) IS-95, and (f) CT2. Assume all receivers have a noise figure of 10 dB.
- 2.15 If a base station provides a signal level of -90 dBm at the cell fringe, find the SNR for each of the mobile receivers described in Problem 2.14.
- 2.16 From first principles, derive the expression for Erlang B given in this chapter.
- 2.17 Carefully analyze the trade-off between sectoring and trunking efficiency for a 4-cell cluster size. While sectoring improves capacity by improving SNR, there is a loss due to decreased trunking efficiency, since each sector must be trunked separately. Consider a wide range of total available channels per cell and consider the impact of using 3 sectors and 6 sectors per cell. Your analysis may involve computer simulation, and should indicate the "break even" point when

sectoring is not practical.

- 2.18 Assume each user of a single base station mobile radio system averages three calls per hour, each call lasting an average of 5 minutes.
- What is the traffic intensity for each user?
 - Find the number of users that could use the system with 1% blocking if only one channel is available.
 - Find the number of users that could use the system with 1% blocking if five trunked channels are available.
 - If the number of users you found in (c) is suddenly doubled, what is the new blocking probability of the five channel trunked mobile radio system? Would this be acceptable performance? Justify why or why not.
- 2.19 The U.S. AMPS system is allocated 50 MHz of spectrum in the 800 MHz range, and provides 832 channels. Forty-two of those channels are control channels. The forward channel frequency is exactly 45 MHz greater than the reverse channel frequency.
- Is the AMPS system simplex, half-duplex, or duplex? What is the bandwidth for each channel and how is it distributed between the base station and the subscriber?
 - Assume a base station transmits control information on channel 352, operating at 880.560 MHz. What is the transmission frequency of a subscriber unit transmitting on channel 352?
 - The A-side and B-side cellular carriers evenly split the AMPS channels. Find the number of voice channels and number of control channels for each carrier.
 - Let's suppose you are chief engineer of a cellular carrier using 7-cell reuse. Propose a channel assignment strategy for a uniform distribution of users throughout your cellular system. Specifically, assume that each cell has 3 control channels (120° sectoring is employed) and specify the number of voice channels you would assign to each control channel in your system.
 - For an ideal hexagonal cellular layout which has identical cell sites, what is the distance between the centers of two nearest co-channel cells for 7-cell reuse? for 4-cell reuse?
- 2.20 Pretend your company won a license to build a U.S. cellular system (the application cost for the license was only \$500!). Your license is to cover 140 square km. Assume a base station costs \$500,000 and a MTSO costs \$1,500,000. An extra \$500,000 is needed to advertise and start the business. You have convinced the bank to loan you \$6 million, with the idea that in four years you will have earned \$10 million in gross billing revenues, and will have paid off the loan.
- How many base stations (i.e. cell sites) will you be able to install for \$6 million?
 - Assuming the earth is flat and subscribers are uniformly distributed on the ground, what assumption can you make about the coverage area of each of your cell sites? What is the major radius of each of your cells, assuming a hexagonal mosaic?
 - Assume that the average customer will pay \$50 per month over a 4 year period. Assume that on the first day you turn your system on, you have a certain number of customers which remains fixed throughout the year. On the first day of each new year the number of customers using your system

doubles and then remains fixed for the rest of that year. What is the minimum number of customers you must have on the first day of service in order to have earned \$10 million in gross billing revenues by the end of the 4th year of operation?

- (d) For your answer in (c), how many users per square km are needed on the first day of service in order to reach the \$10 million mark after the 4th year?